

SG Muslim Care Companion

A local-first guide for Muslim families in Singapore navigating critical illness, end-of-life, and bereavement.

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Disclaimer. This booklet is a community-benefit navigator. It is not a substitute for a qualified asatizah (ARS-certified in Singapore), a licensed medical professional, or a Syariah lawyer. Religious rulings should be confirmed with the Office of the Mufti or your local mosque imam. Medical decisions must be made with the treating doctor. Legal and inheritance decisions should involve the Syariah Court of Singapore or a qualified Muslim lawyer.

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Overview

How to use this companion

How to use this companion

This companion is for Muslim families in Singapore navigating critical illness, the moment of death, and bereavement. It is not a replacement for your *asatizah*, your doctor, or your Syariah lawyer. It will help you find the right people faster and ask the right questions.

Where to start

If your loved one is in the **ICU or palliative care**, start in `10-critical-illness/`.

If death feels imminent, in the next hours, go to `20-imminent-death/`.

If your loved one has just passed away, go to `20-imminent-death/moment-of-death-checklist.md` first, then `30-fardhu-kifayah/` and `40-singapore-admin/` together.

If you are after burial, go to `50-after-burial/` for *iddah*, condolences, commemorations, and grief support.

If you are sorting out inheritance, go to `60-inheritance/`.

If you need financial or community support, go to `70-financial-and-community/`.

What you can expect

- Short pages with plain English and clear next steps.
- Sources listed at the top of every page. Phone numbers and portal links to call or visit.
- Where qualified scholars disagree, the mainstream Singapore-MUIS position is given first, then other respected views are briefly noted, with a recommendation to consult an *asatizah*.

Emergency

If you need urgent help right now:

- Ambulance: **995**
- Police: **999**
- Samaritans of Singapore: **1767** (24 hours)
- National Mindline (mental health): **1771** (24 hours)

For Islamic funeral coordination, the MUIS hotline is **6359 1199** (office hours), and **Masjid Pusara Aman** is at **6792 9378**.

Critical illness

Brain death in Islamic fiqh and Singapore practice

Brain death in Islamic fiqh and Singapore practice

This is an area where qualified scholars disagree. The companion presents the mainstream Singapore-MUIS position first, then briefly notes other respected views. Please consult an asatizah for your family's situation.

The mainstream position (Singapore-MUIS aligned)

The OIC International Islamic Fiqh Academy Resolution No. 17, issued in Amman in October 1986, defined legal death as occurring under either of two conditions: irreversible total cardiorespiratory cessation certified by physicians, or complete cessation of all brain functions where the brain has begun to decompose. In the second case, withdrawing life support is permitted even if the heart continues mechanically ^[1].

The Muslim World League Fiqh Academy (1987) endorsed a similar position. The European Council for Fatwa and Research (Dublin, 2001) also accepts this framework ^{[2][3]}.

MUIS's 2007 fatwa on the Human Organ Transplant Act implicitly accepts brain death as a valid trigger for organ procurement, aligning with the OIC framework ^[4].

A respected minority view

A significant minority of Islamic scholars accept only cardiopulmonary criteria, that is the irreversible stopping of heart and lungs, as the Islamic definition of death. The Islamic Organization for Medical Sciences (IOMS, Kuwait) took a more cautious stance and did not fully equate brain death with

legal death ^{[2][3]}.

Even scholars who reject brain death as "true death" agree that withdrawing life-sustaining treatment is permissible in brain-dead patients, because stable life (*hayah mustaqirra*) is no longer achievable ^[3].

What this means in practice

- All major Islamic bodies converge on the practical point: withdrawing life support is justified when the condition is irreversible.
- For organ donation under HOTA in Singapore, brain death is the relevant trigger, and MUIS permits Muslim participation. See [organ-donation.md](#).
- For the family, the disagreement on defining death may matter emotionally even when the practical decision is similar.

What to talk to the doctor about

- How is brain death determined here? Singapore follows clinical criteria with two independent specialists and confirmatory tests where appropriate.
- Will the team allow time for family to consult an *asatizah*?
- What happens after brain death is declared, in terms of ventilator support, organ donation, and release of the body for *ghusl* and burial?

When in doubt

Ask MUIS at **6359 1199** or the Office of the Mufti for guidance specific to your situation. This page is not a fatwa.

[1]: OIC International Islamic Fiqh Academy, Resolution No. 17 (3/5).

[2]: Brain Death and Islam, Ari et al., Chest 2014.

[3]: WHO EMHJ, Islamic Ethical Perspectives on Life-Sustaining Treatments.

[4]: MUIS fatwa on HOTA 2007.

DNR and withdrawal of treatment in Islam

DNR and withdrawal of treatment in Islam

A Do Not Resuscitate (DNR) order tells the medical team not to attempt cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) if the heart stops. It does not mean stopping other care. Comfort, dignity, hygiene, hydration where possible, pain control, and emotional and spiritual support continue.

The Islamic frame

There is no standalone MUIS fatwa titled "DNR", but the principle is covered by the broader Singapore framework:

- The 1994 MUIS Fatwa Committee allowed Muslims to refuse extraordinary life-sustaining treatment when terminally ill and unable to decide. This is *tawakkal* (trust in God's timing), not euthanasia ^[1].
- ACP and AMD apply this principle in practice. A documented preference against extraordinary intervention covers DNR ^[1].
- The Federation of Islamic Medical Associations confirms DNR consent is permissible when the prognosis is futile ^[2].

Withdrawing vs withholding

Both are permissible in Islamic jurisprudence when treatment is futile and there is no realistic hope of stable life (*la yurja bur'uh*). Major Islamic bodies agree on this in practice, even where scholars differ on definitions of death ^[3].

- **Withholding** is not starting a treatment in the first place.
- **Withdrawing** is stopping a treatment already in place.

Families often feel withdrawing carries more weight than withholding. This is a normal human reaction. From a fiqh perspective, the same standard applies: futility, no realistic hope of recovery, and avoidance of harm.

What to talk to the doctor about

- Is the condition terminal and irreversible? Get this in plain language.
- Is the current treatment aimed at cure, or at keeping organs functioning artificially?
- If CPR were attempted, what is the realistic chance and quality of survival?
- Will palliative care continue if a DNR is in place? Yes is the expected

answer.

Comfort care remains

Pain and symptom relief, including palliative sedation prescribed appropriately, is permitted even if it may hasten death as a side effect, as long as it does not directly cause death ^{[1][2]}.

Documentation

If the patient has capacity, they may sign a DNR with the team. If not, the team will discuss with the family and the LPA donee where one exists. ACP and AMD documents already on file guide the conversation.

For the AMD process and the registry, see MOH Advance Medical Directive ^[4].

When in doubt

Ask the ward for a Muslim chaplain or call MUIS at **6359 1199**. For deeper fiqh questions, the Office of the Mufti is at muis.gov.sg/officeofthemufti. This page is not a fatwa.

^[1]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, Advance Care Planning (English).

^[2]: JBIMA, Bioethics of End-of-Life Medical Care.

^[3]: WHO EMHJ, Islamic Ethical Perspectives on Life-Sustaining Treatments.

^[4]: MOH Advance Medical Directive.

ICU decisions for a Muslim patient

ICU decisions for a Muslim patient

When a loved one is critically ill in ICU, the family often has to take part in decisions about life-sustaining treatment. This page covers the Islamic frame the Office of the Mufti has set out in Singapore, plus how it lines up with the national tools (ACP, AMD, LPA).

The core Islamic principle

Islam values the preservation of life (*hifz al-nafs*). It also recognises that not all treatment is required. The 1994 MUIS Fatwa Committee ruling on the Advance Medical Directive (AMD) said that a Muslim may refuse extraordinary life-sustaining treatment when terminally ill and unable to decide, framing it as *tawakkal* (trust in God's timing). This is not euthanasia, which remains forbidden ^[1].

Pain and symptom relief is permitted even where it may shorten life as a side effect, as long as it does not directly cause death ^[1].

The Singapore tools

- **AMD (Advance Medical Directive)**: a legal document under the AMD Act 1996 stating that you do not want extraordinary life-sustaining treatment if you are terminally ill and unconscious. Witnessed by two persons, including a doctor.
- **ACP (Advance Care Planning)**: a conversation, not a legal document, where you record what matters to you in care. Facilitated by trained ACP facilitators via the [AIC ACP portal](#) ^[5].
- **LPA (Lasting Power of Attorney)**: a legal document appointing someone (a *donee*) to make decisions on your behalf if you lose mental capacity. The 2019 MUIS Fatwa Committee ruled LPA permissible under Islamic law. A donee cannot make or revoke an AMD on your behalf ^[2].

The Office of the Mufti has confirmed that ACP and AMD align with the 1994 fatwa, and ACP is described as a religious right ^{[1][2]}.

Withdrawing vs withholding life-sustaining treatment

Both are permissible in Islamic jurisprudence when treatment is futile and there is no realistic hope of recovery (*la yurja bur'uh*). Withholding (not starting) and withdrawing (stopping) are treated similarly, though families often feel a heavier moral weight around withdrawing. The Federation of Islamic Medical Associations (FIMA) confirms DNR consent is permissible when prognosis is futile ^[6].

Who decides

There is no strict *waris* (inheritance) hierarchy for medical decisions. Consult

immediate family (spouse, adult children) and respect the attending doctor's best-interest assessment ^[1]. If the patient has an LPA donee for personal welfare, that person speaks for the patient.

What to do next

- Ask the team to check if the patient has registered an AMD or has an ACP on file.
- Ask for a meeting to discuss prognosis, goals of care, and time frame for decisions.
- See what - to - ask - doctors .md for a checklist.
- Ask the ward for a Muslim chaplain or call your local mosque. MUIS hotline **6359 1199**.

When in doubt

Ask the Office of the Mufti via muis.gov.sg/officeofthemufti or your local mosque imam. This page is not a fatwa.

[1]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, Advance Care Planning (English).

[2]: MUIS Pre-Planning (LPA and ACP).

[5]: AIC ACP portal.

[6]: JBIMA, Bioethics of End-of-Life Medical Care.

Organ donation and HOTA for Muslims in Singapore

Organ donation and HOTA for Muslims in Singapore

The timeline

- 1973: MUIS prohibited organ donation under the prevailing fiqh of the time.
- 2004: a fatwa simplified opt-in pledging under MTERA, requiring two male

Muslim witnesses.

- 2007: a major pivot. The MUIS Fatwa Committee permitted Muslim participation in the national opt-out scheme under the Human Organ Transplant Act (HOTA) ^{[1][3]}.

How HOTA works

HOTA is an opt-out scheme for Singapore Citizens and Permanent Residents aged 21 to 60. Organs covered are kidney, liver, heart, and corneas. Muslims may opt out entirely or selectively by organ ^{[1][2]}.

The Islamic rationale

The 2007 fatwa rests on three points ^{[1][4]}:

1. The opt-out scheme constitutes lifetime consent. By not opting out, the person is taken to have agreed.
2. *Maslaha*, the public benefit of alleviating extreme suffering of patients with organ failure.
3. The legal maxim *al-mashaqqqa tajlib al-taysir*, "hardship calls for facilitation."

Living donation

Living donation is permissible in Islam when the donation does not cause serious harm to the donor and the recipient is in genuine need ^[4].

How to opt out

If you wish to opt out, the National Organ Transplant Unit (NOTU) handles the process. Visit notu.com.sg for the current form. The MOH amendments page also reflects the operative statute, now referred to in the policy literature as MOTA ^[2].

You may opt out fully or by specific organs. Family members can also raise objections at the time of donation through the relevant procedures.

What to ask the ICU team

- Has the patient opted out of HOTA, or is opt-out being considered now?

- If brain death is confirmed, what is the time frame and process for donation?
- Will the family be allowed to consult an *asatizah* before any decision?
- How will the body be released afterward for *ghusl* and burial? Muslim families need this within hours to fulfil burial within 24 hours where possible.

When in doubt

MUIS hotline **6359 1199**. The Office of the Mufti is at muis.gov.sg/officeofthemufti. This page is not a fatwa.

[1]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, fatwa on HOTA 2007.

[2]: MOH Proposed Amendments to HOTA.

[3]: MOH, The Fatwa and HOTA Forum.

[4]: Perceptions of Organ Donation Among Muslims in Singapore.

What to ask the doctors in ICU

What to ask the doctors in ICU

Use this checklist in family meetings. You do not need to ask everything at once. Pick what is most useful right now.

Prognosis and goals

1. Is the condition terminal and irreversible? In Islamic jurisprudence, *la yurja bur'uh* (no realistic hope of recovery) is the threshold for considering withdrawal or withholding of life-sustaining treatment ^{[1][4]}.
2. Is the current treatment aimed at cure, or at keeping organs functioning artificially?
3. What is the realistic prognosis with and without each intervention? Numbers help.
4. What does "improvement" look like, in your experience, in cases like this?

Documentation already on file

1. Has the patient registered an Advance Medical Directive (AMD)? AMD status is confidential until terminal illness is certified. Ask the clinical team to do an AMD search.
2. Is there an Advance Care Planning document (ACP) on file? ACP guides decisions even though it is not legally binding ^{[1][2]}.
3. Does the patient have a Lasting Power of Attorney (LPA), and if so, who is the donee for personal welfare?
4. What is the patient's HOTA opt-out status? Relevant if brain death is being considered.

Decision-making process

1. How much time do we have before a decision is required? MUIS guidance says family should consult and reach agreement ^[1].
2. Who is the single point of contact in the medical team? What is the escalation path?
3. Can a palliative care or hospital ethics consultation be arranged? Most public hospitals in Singapore have palliative care teams ^[3].
4. If a DNR is in place or being considered, what other care continues? The expected answer is "everything else." See `dnr-and-withdrawal.md`.

Spiritual and practical needs

1. Can a Muslim religious officer (asatizah) or chaplain visit at the bedside? Wards will facilitate this. Families can also contact a local mosque directly. MUIS hotline **6359 1199** ^[3].
2. Can we have quiet time and privacy for Quran recitation and prayer at the bedside?
3. Can the team avoid scheduling non-urgent procedures during the five daily prayer times where possible?
4. If the patient is in the final hours, how will the team support *talqin* and family being at the bedside? See `20-imminent-death/talqin.md`.

After death

1. What is the body-release process after death? Muslim families typically

need release within hours to begin *ghusl*, *kafan*, and burial within 24 hours.

2. Who completes the Certificate of Cause of Death (CCOD), and how will the digital death certificate reach us? See [40-singapore-admin/ccod-and-ica.md](#).

3. If brain death is declared and HOTA applies, what is the timeline for organ donation and body release? See [organ-donation.md](#).

When in doubt

If something is unclear, ask again in plain language. You are allowed to say "I do not understand, please explain it differently."

For religious questions, MUIS hotline **6359 1199**, or your local mosque imam. This page is not a substitute for a doctor or for an *asatizah*.

[1]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, Advance Care Planning (English).

[2]: AIC ACP portal.

[3]: PCNOW, End-of-Life Care Considerations for Muslim Patients.

[4]: JBIMA, Bioethics of End-of-Life Medical Care.

Imminent death

At the bedside in the final hours

At the bedside in the final hours

Being at the bedside of someone who is dying is one of the heaviest things a person can do. Islam gives us a frame for this moment that is gentle, not theatrical. The patient comes first.

What to do

- Keep voices low. The room should feel calm.
- Recite the *shahadah* softly near the patient. Do not command, prompt. See [talqin.md](#).
- Recite *Surah Ya-Sin* if the family is comfortable doing so. This is widely practised in Singapore ^[2].
- Ask the patient if they want water, repositioning, or to have someone hold their hand. Small comforts matter.
- If they are conscious, offer them the chance to make *tawbah* (repentance) and to forgive others. Help them say good things, encourage hope in Allah's mercy.
- Make du'a for them and for yourself. Du'a may be in any language.
- Position the patient facing the *qibla* if the medical team allows. In Singapore, this is roughly to the northwest ^[1].

What not to do

- Do not argue at the bedside about anything. Disagreements about visitors, treatment, or arrangements should be discussed outside the room.
- Do not let the room fill with loud crying or wailing. Grief is natural, but loud lamentation is discouraged. Quiet tears are normal and accepted.

- Do not photograph or film the patient. Protect their dignity.

Visitors

In Islam, visiting the sick is a sunnah. In the final hours, keep visits short and gentle. Limit numbers to what the patient can manage. Spouses, parents, children, and siblings have priority. The ward will set its own limits.

If the patient is asleep or sedated, you can still recite Quran near them. They may still hear, even when they cannot respond.

What to ask the ward

- Can we have privacy and quiet at the bedside?
- If they are alert, can we briefly position them toward the *qibla*?
- Can a Muslim religious officer come to the ward? Call MUIS at **6359 1199** or contact your local mosque.
- If death is near, what will happen next, and how soon can the body be released?
- Who will issue the Certificate of Cause of Death? See `40-singapore-admin/ccod-and-ica.md`.

Looking after yourself

You can only be present for others if you have something left to give. Step out for water. Eat something. Pray on time, even if briefly, in the family room. Let others take turns at the bedside ^[4].

Tell the ward you need a Muslim chaplain not just for the patient but for you, if that helps. The Office of the Mufti curriculum module on *grief and suffering in Islam* notes that *sabr* (patience) does not mean suppressing feelings; it means persevering with trust in Allah while still expressing what you feel.

If you cannot be there

Call. Speak softly. Recite the *shahadah* over the phone if the family at the bedside can hold the phone near the patient's ear. Make du'a from wherever you are.

When death happens

Move to [moment-of-death-checklist.md](#) for the next steps. There is no rush in the first minutes. Sit. Breathe. Say *Inna lillahi wa inna ilayhi raji'un* ("indeed, to Allah we belong, and to Him we shall return"). Then begin the steps when you are ready.

When in doubt

This page is not a substitute for an *asatizah* or a doctor. Ask the ward chaplain, call MUIS at **6359 1199**, or your local mosque. For severe distress, the National Mindline is **1771** (24 hours) and Samaritans of Singapore is **1767** (24 hours) ^[4].

^[1]: British Fatwa Council, Islamic Etiquettes for Dealing with a Person on Their Deathbed.

^[2]: Henry Ford Health, What Should a Dying Patient and Family Members Do in Islam.

^[4]: MuslimSG, Mental health and well-being in Islam.

Moment of death checklist

Moment of death checklist

This is the first hour. Take a breath. Read this only if you need it. Skip what does not apply.

Right after death, at the bedside

1. Sit. Say *Inna lillahi wa inna ilayhi raji'un*.
2. Gently close the eyes and mouth of the deceased. Cover the body with a clean sheet.
3. Tie the jaw lightly with a clean cloth if needed, to keep the mouth closed. Position the limbs straight if they are not already.
4. Recite the *shahadah*, *al-Fatihah*, *al-Ikhlās*, and short *du'a* softly. Quiet tears are fine. Loud wailing is discouraged in Islam ^[1].
5. If at home, turn the body to face the *qibla* (roughly northwest in Singapore)

if practical ^[2].

You do not need to do *ghusl* now. That happens later, by a trained washer of the same gender. See 30-fardhu-kifayah/ghusl.md.

In hospital

1. Tell the nurse. The attending doctor will certify death and issue the Certificate of Cause of Death (CCOD) online. Since 29 May 2022, this auto-registers the death with ICA. The hospital will give the family the certificate number and details needed to download the digital death certificate from *My Legacy* ^[3].
2. Ask the ward how long the body can stay in the room or be moved to a holding area, so the family can begin arrangements.
3. Call a Muslim funeral service provider. See 40-singapore-admin/funeral-service-providers.md for options including 24-hour numbers. They will collect the body, do *ghusl* and *kafan*, arrange *solat jenazah*, and coordinate burial.

At home

1. If at home, call the deceased's regular doctor or a 24-hour house call doctor. If no doctor is reachable, call the police at **999** ^[4].
2. If the death is sudden or unexplained, the police will arrange transfer to Mortuary @ HSA (Block 9, Singapore General Hospital). The case may go to the Coroner. This can delay burial. Tell your funeral director and mosque so arrangements adjust.

Calls to make

- **Muslim funeral director:** choose one provider, not many. They will project-manage. See 40-singapore-admin/funeral-service-providers.md.
- **Family and close friends:** short messages are best. Mention place and time later, when known.
- **MUIS:** **6359 1199** for religious guidance and coordination, especially if the deceased has no close family.

- **Local mosque:** for *solat jenazah* and ustaz support, especially for *talqin* at the bedside.

Paperwork the funeral director will handle

The funeral director, in consultation with you, will typically handle:

- Download of the digital death certificate from [My Legacy](#) within 30 days using your *Singpass* ^[3].
- Application for the **Permit to Bury** via the [NEA ePortal](#), which is free.
- Booking the burial slot at the **Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Complex** (NEA), **6225 5632**, Mon to Sun 8:30am to 4:30pm, closed 1pm to 2pm. The Muslim cemetery adult plot fee is **\$315** for citizens and PRs. See [40-singapore-admin/muis-burial-booking.md](#).
- Coordination of *ghusl*, *kafan*, transport, and *solat jenazah*.

In the first few hours

- Drink water. Eat something simple. You will need to keep going.
- Decide where *solat jenazah* will be: home, void deck, or mosque. Many families pray at the local mosque before going to the cemetery. See [30-fardhu-kifayah/solat-jenazah.md](#).
- Decide whether you want the burial today (if before late afternoon) or tomorrow morning. Islamic practice is burial as soon as possible, ideally within 24 hours, but practical constraints (paperwork, transport, family arriving) sometimes shift this slightly.

When in doubt

Call your funeral director first, then MUIS at **6359 1199**, then your local mosque imam. This page is a checklist, not a fatwa or legal advice.

^[1]: British Fatwa Council, Islamic Etiquettes for Dealing with a Person on Their Deathbed.

^[2]: Jasa Budi Muslim Casket, Muslim Burial Rites in Singapore.

^[3]: NEA, When death occurs in a hospital.

^[4]: NEA, When death occurs at home.

Talqin at the bedside

Talqin at the bedside

Talqin comes from the Arabic *laqqana*, "to instruct" or "to prompt." It is the gentle act of guiding a dying Muslim to say the *shahadah* (the testimony of faith) so that, if possible, their last words on earth are the affirmation of *tawhid*.

This page is about bedside *talqin* for a dying person. There is a separate practice called graveside *talqin* done after burial, in the Shafi'i tradition.

The hadith basis

The Prophet, peace be upon him, said: "Prompt your dying person to say *la ilaha illallah*." This is reported by Abu Sa'id al-Khudri and recorded in Sahih Muslim, hadith 916a ^[1].

What is recited

- *La ilaha illallah*, "there is no god but Allah." This is the core and is universally practised ^{[1][2]}.
- *La ilaha illallah Muhammadur rasulullah*, the full testimony, used where appropriate (for example for a revert).
- *Surah Ya-Sin*. Widely practised in Singapore and the Nusantara region. Scholars differ on the strength of the hadith for this. Ibn Baz and Ibn Uthaymin graded it weak but noted general Quran recitation at the bedside is beneficial. The practice is broadly accepted in the Shafi'i tradition dominant in Singapore ^{[1][2]}.
- Other short surahs and *istighfar* (seeking forgiveness) where helpful.

How to do it gently

The Prophetic instruction is to *prompt*, not to command. Recite the *shahadah* yourself, softly, near the dying person. Do not say "say it" or repeatedly press them. If they respond, that is good. If they do not, continue to recite, and ask

Allah to make their condition easy.

The aim is comfort and a peaceful state, not pressure. If the family becomes loud, it may distress the patient. Keep voices low and the atmosphere calm.

Positioning

If practically possible and not medically contraindicated, position the patient facing the *qibla* (direction of the Kaaba in Makkah). In Singapore, the qibla is roughly to the northwest. Hospital beds and ICU equipment may limit this. Check with the nurse before moving.

Who does it

Any present family member who can recite. If the family is unable, ask the ward for a Muslim chaplain or call a local mosque. Many mosques in Singapore can send a religious officer for this. MUIS hotline **6359 1199** can help with coordination.

What to bring or do

- A small Quran or your phone with a Quran app, headphones optional.
- A clean glass of water in case the patient asks.
- A copy of common bedside du'a, in case you forget under stress.
- Tissues, and patience.

After death

After the patient passes away, the family may continue to recite the *shahadah*, *al-Fatihah*, *al-Ikhlās*, and short du'a near the body. The next steps are in `moment-of-death-checklist.md`, then `30-fardhu-kifayah/`.

The graveside *talqin* practice (reminding the deceased of their testimony after burial) is separate and is performed by one person standing at the head of the grave. See `30-fardhu-kifayah/burial.md` for that.

When in doubt

Ask the ward chaplain or call your local mosque. The Office of the Mufti is at muis.gov.sg/officeofthemufti for fiqh questions. This page is not a fatwa.

[2]: British Fatwa Council, Islamic Etiquettes for Dealing with a Person on Their Deathbed.

Fardhu kifayah

Burial in Singapore

Burial in Singapore

Timing

Islamic practice asks for burial as soon as possible, ideally within 24 hours of death. In Singapore, NEA processes Muslim burials expeditiously to support this. Practical delays (Coroner referral, paperwork, family arriving) sometimes shift the timing slightly; consult your funeral director and imam ^[1].

Where

The only active Muslim burial ground in Singapore is the **Muslim Cemetery** within the **Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Complex**, located near the western end of Lim Chu Kang Road. **Masjid Pusara Aman** is on site for *solat jenazah* and family use ^[2].

The lahad and the modular concrete system

A *lahad* is a niche cut into the side wall of the grave so the body rests in it rather than directly under the soil. This is the preferred Muslim grave type.

Since 2007, NEA has used a **modular concrete crypt system** for Muslim burials. The MUIS Fatwa Committee, in 2001, confirmed that this system is permissible under Islamic law, on the condition that the *lahad* niche is preserved inside the concrete crypt. The fatwa also confirmed that a grave depth of about 2.5 feet is acceptable when sealed with the concrete lid, since the seal serves the purposes that classical fiqh requires of greater depth (protection from animals, containment) ^[1].

Orientation

The body is placed on its right side, facing the *qibla* (the Kaaba in Makkah).

In Singapore, this is roughly to the northwest.

Lowering the body

- Three to four people typically descend into the grave to receive the *jenazah*.
- The body is lowered gently, still in the *kafan* (no coffin), and turned onto its right side facing the *qibla*.
- Timber boards or supports may be placed over the body before sealing ^[5].
- NEA uses an excavator to fill the surface where applicable. Mourners step back during this stage.

Graveside talqin and du'a

After burial, in the Shafi'i tradition followed by most Singapore Muslims, one person stands at the head of the grave and recites a *talqin*, gently reminding the deceased of the *shahadah*. Du'a is then made for the deceased.

This graveside *talqin* is different from the bedside *talqin* discussed in 20-imminent-death/talqin.md. Scholarly views vary on the graveside *talqin*. The Singapore community practice broadly accepts it; ask your imam if you would like fiqh detail.

Family conduct at the cemetery

- Quiet, respectful, focused on the *jenazah* and on du'a.
- Mourners may toss three handfuls of soil into the grave.
- Loud wailing is discouraged. Quiet tears and prayers are accepted.
- Photographing the body or the grave is discouraged in the mainstream Singapore-MUIS position. Some scholarly opinions allow restrained documentation; if it matters to your family, consult your *asatizah*.

Women at burial

There are scholarly differences on women going to the cemetery. The mainstream Singapore practice discourages it for women, on the basis of a hadith. Some respected scholars allow it as long as women observe restraint and modesty. The choice often comes down to family practice. Consult your

imam if unsure.

Fees and the 15-year lease

- Singapore Citizens and PRs: **\$315** for an adult plot, **\$140** for a child below 10, both under a 15-year lease.
- Foreigners with qualifying immediate next-of-kin: **\$1,880**.
- Payment is by NETS, CashCard, or credit card. Cash is not accepted at the NEA counter ^[4].

After 15 years, NEA exhumes the remains and re-inter them in smaller individual plots at Pusara Abadi or Pusara Aman within the same complex.

See [40-singapore-admin/pusara-aman.md](#) and

[40-singapore-admin/choa-chu-kang-muslim-cemetery.md](#).

After burial

The next stages are bigger than they look:

- Tahlil and commemorations, see [50-after-burial/tahlil-and-commemorations.md](#).
- Iddah for a widow, see [50-after-burial/iddah.md](#).
- Inheritance, see [60-inheritance/](#).
- Grief and mental health, see [50-after-burial/grief-and-mental-health.md](#).

When in doubt

Ask your funeral director, your imam, or MUIS at **6359 1199**. For NEA processes, **6225 5632**.

^[1]: MUIS Fatwa on Exhumation 2001.

^[2]: NEA, Choa Chu Kang Cemetery.

^[4]: Singapore Muslim Casket and Marble Contractor, Burial fee page.

^[5]: Ihsan Casket, Method of lowering the body.

Ghusl jenazah, washing the deceased

Ghusl jenazah, washing the deceased

Ghusl jenazah is the ritual washing of the body. It is *fardhu kifayah*, a communal obligation. If enough qualified Muslims fulfil it, the rest of the community is excused.

Who performs it

- Close family members of the **same gender** as the deceased, or a trained *jurumandi* (washer) if the family is unable ^{[1][2]}.
- Males wash males. Females wash females. A spouse may wash their deceased partner.
- For a child below the age of distinguishing gender, either male or female adults may wash.

Awrah and dignity

The *awrah* of the deceased must remain covered throughout. The washers should wear gloves. Whatever they see must not be discussed outside the washing room. This is a strict *adab* ^[1].

Supplies needed

- A *mandi jenazah* tray or table in a private, enclosed space.
- Clean water.
- Mild soap.
- Camphor (*kapur barus*), and optional rose water or mild fragrance.
- Disposable gloves.
- Clean towels.
- Cotton wool.
- A modesty cloth (*satar*) to keep the *awrah* covered.

Most Muslim funeral service providers in Singapore supply a full *mandi jenazah* kit. **Masjid Pusara Aman** has a licensed on-site funeral parlour available to the community, free of charge ^[4].

Step-by-step (general Shafi'i practice as commonly

done in Singapore)

1. Lay the body on a clean, slightly inclined tray in a private space.
2. Remove all clothing, hospital tags, IV lines, jewellery, and accessories. Cover the *awrah* with the *satar*.
3. Gently press the abdomen to expel any remaining matter, then clean.
4. Clean the *istinja* (private areas) with gloved hands, without direct touching.
5. Perform *wudhu* on the body: face, arms to elbows, head, feet. Do not introduce water into the mouth or nostrils.
6. Wash the body starting from the head (hair and face, beard for men), then the upper right, upper left, lower right, lower left.
7. Turn the body gently to the left and wash the back, then to the right and wash the other side.
8. For a female deceased: loosen the hair, wash it, comb it, and braid into three braids placed behind the back ^[3].
9. Final pour: camphor-infused water from head to toe, three times.
10. Dry the body with a clean towel. Maintain the *satar* throughout.

The minimum is one wash; an odd number (one, three, or seven) is preferred for cleanliness.

Where to do it in Singapore

- **At home:** possible if there is a private space and supplies. The funeral director can bring trained washers and equipment.
- **At Masjid Pusara Aman:** the on-site licensed parlour at 11 Lim Chu Kang Road. The community uses this when home space is not available, or for cases without close family. Free of charge ^[4].
- **At a private Muslim funeral home:** most major providers (see 40-singapore-admin/funeral-service-providers.md) include ghusl in their packages.

Special cases

- **Highly infectious disease:** follow the medical team's instructions and the

funeral director's protective procedures. MUIS issued guidance during the pandemic that adapted the ritual where necessary while preserving its essence ^[5].

- **Severe physical injury:** the funeral director will adapt the process. The principle is to honour the body without causing further damage.
- **Stillborn or very young child:** there are specific rulings; ask your imam or the funeral director.

After ghusl

The body is wrapped in *kafan*. See *kafan.md*. Then *solat jenazah*. See *solat-jenazah.md*. Then burial. See *burial.md*.

When in doubt

Call MUIS at **6359 1199** or **Masjid Pusara Aman** at **6792 9378**. Your funeral director can also arrange a trained washer if no family member is available.

- [1]: Ihsan Casket, Muslim Burial and Funeral Management.
- [2]: Jasa Budi Muslim Casket, Muslim Burial Rites in Singapore.
- [3]: Amaliah, Step-by-step guide on how to perform ghusl after death.
- [4]: Masjid Pusara Aman, About.
- [5]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, advisory on conducting funeral prayers.

Kafan, shrouding the deceased

Kafan, shrouding the deceased

Kafan is the simple, white, unsewn shroud that wraps the deceased before burial. It is a reminder that all of us leave this world the same way: with nothing but a few yards of plain cloth.

How many cloths

discouraged.

Fabric requirements

- Plain white cotton, inexpensive and clean.
- No silk, no stitching, no gold or decoration.
- Slightly larger than the body, to allow tying at head and feet.

Wrapping method (male)

1. Lay all three sheets flat, stacked.
2. Roll the top sheet (*qamees*) up from the front toward the head.
3. Lift the body, still covered with the *satar* (modesty cloth) from the *ghusl*, and lay it on the sheets.
4. Unroll the *qamees* over the front of the body. Remove the *satar* once the body is covered.
5. Wrap the remaining two sheets (*lifafah*) around the body, right side first, then left.
6. Fasten with four tie ropes: one above the head, one below the feet, two around the body ^{[1][3]}.

Wrapping method (female)

1. Same base layer sequence; add the *sinaband* from armpits to thighs after the *qamees*.
2. Place the head veil over the head and hair.
3. Bring the two braids forward, one on each side of the chest.
4. Complete with the outer *lifafah*. Fasten with three or four ties.
5. If the deceased was in menstruation or post-partum bleeding, use absorbent padding to prevent seepage ^[2].

Where to obtain in Singapore

- All licensed Muslim funeral service providers supply pre-cut, pre-folded *kafan* sets. See 40-singapore-admin/funeral-service-providers.md. The minimum permissible *kafan* is one cloth covering the entire body. Three (male) and five (female) is the *Sunnah* standard. Extravagance is

- **Masjid Pusara Aman** and mosque-linked *pengurus jenazah* teams carry ready *kafan*.
- Many providers (Ihsan Casket, Singapore Muslim Casket and Marble Contractor, Takdir, and others) include *kafan* in their packages ^[1].

After kafan

The body is now ready for *solat jenazah*. See `solat-jenazah.md`. Then burial. See `burial.md`.

When in doubt

Call your funeral director. They handle *kafan* selection, sizing, and the wrapping itself for most families.

[1]: Ihsan Casket, Muslim Burial and Funeral Management.

[2]: Amaliah, Step-by-step guide on how to perform ghusl after death.

[3]: Jasa Budi Muslim Casket, Muslim Burial Rites in Singapore.

Solat jenazah, the funeral prayer

Solat jenazah, the funeral prayer

Solat jenazah is the funeral prayer. It is *fardhu kifayah*, a communal obligation. If enough Muslims in the community perform it, the obligation is discharged for all.

Key features

- It is short. Four *takbir*, no *ruku*, no *sujud*.
- Stand only. The congregation faces the body, which is placed in front of the *imam*.
- Minimum one person can perform it; forming three rows is encouraged (*sunnah*).
- An *imam* leads: ideally a qualified *asatizah*, or the eldest or most learned male present ^[1].

Where it can be held

- **At a mosque:** any mosque may host *solat jenazah*. Masjid Pusara Aman serves families who lack space at home or whose loved one will be buried at the cemetery directly.
- **At home or at a void deck:** permissible and common in Singapore.
- **In absentia (solat al-ghayb): allowed when the deceased is overseas, or one cannot attend. Performed once ghusl* has been completed. Generally valid up to one month after death* ^[2].

Niat (intention)

The intention is from the heart, but a verbal form is commonly used:

- Male deceased: *Usolli 'ala hadhal mayyiti arba'a takbiratin fardhal kifayati ma'muman lillahi ta'ala.*
- Female deceased: *Usolli 'ala hadhihil mayyitati arba'a takbiratin fardhal kifayati ma'muman lillahi ta'ala.*

If you are leading, replace *ma'muman* (follower) with *imaman* (leading) ^{[1][3]}.

The four takbir

***1st takbir** (Takbiratul Ihram): *raise hands to the earlobes, say Allahu Akbar. Recite Surah al-Fatihah** silently.

2nd takbir: say *Allahu Akbar*. Recite *salawat* upon the Prophet. The short form is *Allahumma solli 'ala Sayyidina Muhammad*.

3rd takbir: say *Allahu Akbar*. Recite the *du'a* for the deceased. A common form:

- For a male: *Allahummaghfir lahu warhamhu wa 'afihi wa'fu 'anhu.*
- For a female: change the pronouns: *Allahummaghfir laha warhamha wa 'afiha wa'fu 'anha.*

4th takbir: say *Allahu Akbar*. Recite a closing *du'a*, such as *Allahumma la tahrinna ajrahu wa la taftinna ba'dahu waghfirlana wa lahu.*

Salam: turn the head right, *Assalamu alaikum wa rahmatullahi wa barakatuh*. Then left.

Etiquette

- Quiet, focused, and brief. The prayer is for the deceased, not a performance.
- Do not photograph the body or the gathering.
- Women may attend the prayer. Local custom varies on whether women come to the cemetery. See [burial.md](#) for the scholarly views on that.

After the prayer

The body is taken to the cemetery. The funeral director coordinates transport. See [40-singapore-admin/transport-and-logistics.md](#). The next stage is burial. See [burial.md](#).

When in doubt

Ask your imam, your funeral director, or MUIS at **6359 1199**. For the full Malay-language guidance from the Office of the Mufti, see muis.gov.sg ^[4].

[1]: MuslimSG, How to Perform Solat Jenazah.

[2]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, advisory on funeral prayers (English).

[3]: Ihsan Casket, Steps for Salat ul Jenazah.

[4]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, advisory during circuit breaker (Malay).

Singapore admin

Certificate of Cause of Death and ICA registration

Certificate of Cause of Death and ICA registration

Since 29 May 2022, Singapore's death registration process is fully digital. The attending doctor certifies death online. ICA auto-registers the death. The family downloads the digital death certificate from the *My Legacy* portal ^[3].

Who can issue the CCOD

Any doctor registered with the Singapore Medical Council (SMC) can issue the Certificate of Cause of Death, provided they can determine the cause and the case does not require Coroner referral. This includes general practitioners, home care doctors, and hospital doctors ^[1].

Hospital death

1. The attending doctor certifies death online. The system auto-registers with ICA ^[4].
2. Hospital staff give the next-of-kin (NOK) the death certificate number, the deceased's ID number, and the date of death.
3. NOK logs in to [My Legacy](#) with *Singpass* and downloads the digital death certificate.

Home death

1. Contact the deceased's regular doctor or a 24-hour house call GP ^[5].
2. If no doctor is reachable, or the death is sudden or unexplained, call the police at **999**. The body is transported to **Mortuary @ HSA** (Block 9, Singapore General Hospital) in a police hearse.

4. This process can delay burial. Tell your funeral director and mosque so arrangements adjust.

Downloading the digital death certificate

- URL: mylegacy.life.gov.sg.
- Log in with **Singpass** (two-factor required).
- Enter the death certificate number, deceased's NRIC/FIN/passport number, and date of death.
- **Download within 30 days.** After 30 days, the certificate is no longer free to download; a paid extract must be requested instead ^[2].
- No fee for registration or initial download.

If you cannot navigate the online process

A 24-hour assistance hotline is available at **6589 8707**. In-person help is at ICA Building and ServiceSG Centres ^[2].

If the system is offline

The doctor issues a **manual Confirmation of Death (mCOD)** document. NEA accepts this in place of the digital certificate for burial booking and the Permit to Bury ^[4].

What the doctor records

Full name, sex, ID number, date of birth, date and time of death, place of death, and cause of death.

What comes next

- Apply for the **Permit to Bury** via the [NEA ePortal](#). Free. Your funeral director typically handles this. See [muis-burial-booking.md](#).
- Book the burial slot at the **Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Complex**. See [muis-burial-booking.md](#).
- Begin *ghusl*, *kafan*, and *solat jenazah*. See [30-fardhu-kifayah/](#).

When in doubt

Call your funeral director first. They have done this many times. For ICA help, **6589 8707** (24 hours). For NEA, **6225 5632** (Mon to Sun 8:30am to 4:30pm, closed 1pm to 2pm).

[1]: MOH, All SMC-registered doctors can certify cause of death.

[2]: ICA, Register and Download Digital Death Certificate.

[3]: MOH, Streamlining birth and death registration processes.

[4]: NEA, When death occurs in a hospital.

[5]: NEA, When death occurs at home.

Choa Chu Kang Muslim Cemetery

Choa Chu Kang Muslim Cemetery

The Choa Chu Kang Muslim Cemetery is the only operational Muslim burial site in Singapore. There is no separate active Muslim cemetery distinct from the Pusara Aman and Pusara Abadi sections; they are all within the Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Complex administered by NEA ^[1].

The modular concrete crypt system

In 2007, NEA introduced the modular concrete crypt system for Muslim burials: underground concrete compartments replace traditional earth plots. This significantly increases space efficiency ^[2].

The MUIS Fatwa Committee in 2001 confirmed the modular system is permissible under Islamic law, on condition that the *lahad* niche is preserved within the concrete crypt. The fatwa also accepted a grave depth of about 2.5 feet under this sealed system, as the seal achieves the protective purposes that classical fiqh requires of deeper graves ^[3].

The 15-year rotation

Since 1 November 1998, all graves in Singapore are subject to a 15-year burial period. After 15 years, NEA exhumes the remains. For Muslims, where re-burial is mandated rather than cremation, the remains are re-interred in

smaller individual plots at the **Pusara Abadi** section ^[2].

Long-term capacity

With the modular system, the cemetery is projected to remain operational for many decades, with NEA estimates suggesting viability through to the early 22nd century in current planning ^[4].

NEA also runs phased exhumations as part of the Tengah Air Base expansion programme. See [pusara-aman.md](#) for details on phases and Tengah impact.

The Pusara Aman vs Pusara Abadi sections

- **Pusara Aman**: main burial area for new Muslim burials.
- **Pusara Abadi**: section for re-interred remains after exhumation.

Both are within the same complex, served by the same on-site mosque (Masjid Pusara Aman) and the same NEA Cemetery Office.

How to apply for a burial plot

See [muis-burial-booking.md](#) for the booking process. In summary:

1. **Permit to Bury**, free, via the NEA ePortal.
2. **Burial slot**, booked at the Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Office at **940 Old Choa Chu Kang Road, 6225 5632**.
3. **Fee**, \$315 for adult citizens/PRs.

When in doubt

NEA Cemetery Office: **6225 5632**. MUIS: **6359 1199**. Masjid Pusara Aman: **6792 9378**.

^[1]: NEA, Burial, Cremation and Ash Management.

^[2]: NEA, Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Exhumation Programme.

^[3]: MUIS Fatwa on Exhumation 2001.

^[4]: Pusara Aman Muslim Cemetery, Wikipedia background article.

Muslim funeral service providers in Singapore

Muslim funeral service providers in Singapore

You only need one funeral service provider. They will project-manage the next 24 to 48 hours: *ghusl*, *kafan*, *solat jenazah*, NEA paperwork, transport, and burial.

The mosque-based fallback

Masjid Pusara Aman is Singapore's only mosque with a licensed funeral parlour on site. It is the designated community fallback for cases where the deceased has no close family, or where *ghusl* and *solat jenazah* cannot be held at home or a local mosque. Services are provided free of charge for the community ^[1].

Masjid Pusara Aman 11 Lim Chu Kang Road, Singapore 719452 Tel 6792 9378 Bus 172 or 405 from Bukit Panjang Interchange.

Private Muslim funeral service providers

The providers below appear on the NCID infection-control-qualified funeral services providers list (most recent update September 2025). Prices are indicative and subject to change. Always confirm directly ^[2].

Provider	Services	Indicative package	Contact
Ihsan Casket ^[3]	All-in: <i>ghusl</i> , <i>kafan</i> , <i>imam</i> , permits, hearse, carpet grass, <i>tahlil</i>	From \$1,400 (excludes NEA \$315 fee)	24-hour line, see website

Provider	Services	Indicative package	Contact
Singapore Muslim Casket and Marble Contractor ^[4]	Full burial package including qualified <i>tukang mandi</i> and <i>imam</i>	From \$1,570 + \$315 NEA fee	Website contact
Takdir Pengurusan Jenazah ^[5]	Complete funeral management since 2005, optional 24-hour doctor standby, optional food for around 50 pax	Package on enquiry	See website
Jasa Budi Muslim Casket Services ^[6]	<i>Ghusl</i> , <i>kafan</i> , <i>solat jenazah</i> , optional repatriation	On enquiry	See website
Mas Services (Al-Ikhlash) ^[7]	MUIS-affiliated; also runs community <i>kursus pengurusan jenazah</i>	On enquiry	See website

These are not endorsements. The maintainer of this companion is not commercially affiliated with any provider. Please verify reputation, pricing, and current operating status yourself.

What "all-in" usually covers

Most all-in packages typically include:

- Hospital or home pickup.
- *Ghusl* and *kafan* by trained staff.
- Plain white *kafan* and basic supplies.
- *Solat jenazah* coordination at a mosque or void deck.
- Family bus (often around 33 to 50 seats).
- Hearse to Choa Chu Kang Muslim Cemetery.
- Carpet grass and basic graveside setup.
- Liaison with NEA for the Permit to Bury and the slot.

Optional extras: extra cars, *tahlil* arrangements, doctor standby, meals for guests, repatriation services if the deceased is from overseas or being sent overseas.

Community courses (kursus pengurusan jenazah)

Several mosques run periodic one to two day courses on *jenazah* management, covering *ghusl*, *kafan*, *solat jenazah*, and burial etiquette. Recent examples include sessions at Masjid Al-Amin and Masjid Al Abdul Razak, and a long-running course at SimplyIslam. Listings appear at islamicevents.sg ^[8].

These courses are how community *pengurus jenazah* teams are trained over time.

How to choose a provider in a hurry

- Pick one within 30 minutes of your first call. Do not shop around in the first hour.
- Ask: do they handle NEA paperwork end-to-end, what is included in the package, what is the all-in price, and how soon can they pick up the body.
- If you have a preferred *imam* or mosque, tell them upfront so they coordinate.
- If the deceased has no close family or limited funds, call **Masjid Pusara Aman** at **6792 9378** or **MUIS** at **6359 1199** first.

When in doubt

MUIS hotline: **6359 1199**. Masjid Pusara Aman: **6792 9378**. NEA Cemetery Office: **6225 5632**.

- [1]: Masjid Pusara Aman, About.
- [2]: NCID infection-control-qualified funeral services providers list.
- [3]: Ihsan Casket, Muslim Funeral Services.
- [4]: Singapore Muslim Casket and Marble Contractor, Burial fee.
- [5]: Takdir Pengurusan Jenazah.
- [6]: Jasa Budi Muslim Casket Services.
- [7]: Mas Services (Al-Ikhlas).
- [8]: IslamicEvents.SG, Kursus Pengurusan Jenazah listings.

MUIS burial booking, Permit to Bury, and the NEA slot

MUIS burial booking, Permit to Bury, and the NEA slot

A small but important point: **MUIS does not run a separate Muslim burial booking portal**. Burial slot booking and the Permit to Bury are both handled by NEA. MUIS provides religious guidance, and the on-site mosque at Pusara Aman serves prayer needs at the cemetery ^[1].

Step 1, Permit to Bury (free)

Apply via the [NEA ePortal](#) under "Application for Permit to Bury Body." Your funeral director typically handles this. Information needed ^[2]:

- Digital death certificate number, or the manual Confirmation of Death (mCOD) if the system was offline.
- Deceased's name, religion, intended burial location.
- NOK's NRIC or passport, and relationship to the deceased.

There is no fee for the Permit to Bury itself.

Step 2, book the burial slot

Call or visit:

- **Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Complex**, 940 Old Choa Chu Kang Road, Singapore 698910.
- Tel: **6225 5632**.
- Hours: Mon to Sun, 8:30am to 4:30pm, closed 1pm to 2pm.

Bring ^[3]:

- Digital death certificate (PDF or printed).
- Deceased's NRIC or passport.
- Permit to Bury reference.
- Applicant's NRIC.
- Letter of authorisation if the applicant is not a direct NOK.

Fees (Singapore Citizens and PRs)

Plot	Fee	Lease
Muslim cemetery adult plot	\$315	15 years
Child below 10	\$140	15 years
Foreigners with qualifying NOK	\$1,880	15 years

Payment is by NETS, CashCard, or credit card. Cash is not accepted ^[4].

How quickly can a slot be available

NEA processes Muslim burials quickly to support the Islamic obligation of burial within 24 hours where possible. Funeral directors familiar with Muslim processes can accelerate logistics significantly.

Religious coordination

- **MUIS hotline: 6359 1199** (office hours), for Islamic funeral guidance, especially for cases involving deceased without next-of-kin.

- **Masjid Pusara Aman: 6792 9378**, for *solat jenazah* and procession arrangements at the cemetery.

What if the death needs Coroner review

If the death goes to the Coroner (sudden or unexplained), burial is delayed until the body is released. The funeral director and mosque adjust. See [ccod-and-ica.md](#) for the Coroner pathway.

What comes next

Once the slot is booked and the body is ready, the procession typically runs:

1. Pickup from hospital or home.
2. *Ghusl* and *kafan* at home or at a funeral parlour or at Masjid Pusara Aman.
3. *Solat jenazah* at a mosque, home, or void deck.
4. Transport to the cemetery for burial. See [transport-and-logistics.md](#).

When in doubt

Call your funeral director. They book burial slots regularly and know the procedures end-to-end. NEA at **6225 5632** for direct help.

[1]: NEA, Burial, Cremation and Ash Management.

[2]: NEA, Application for Permit to Bury Body via ePortal.

[3]: The Final Amanah Guidebook.

[4]: Singapore Muslim Casket and Marble Contractor, Burial fee page.

Pusara Aman mosque and cemetery

Pusara Aman mosque and cemetery

Masjid Pusara Aman is located at the Muslim Cemetery complex, **11 Lim Chu Kang Road, Singapore 719452**. Tel **6792 9378**. Built in 1972, it is a single-storey mosque serving those accompanying burial processions.

Capacity is around 200. It hosts daily and Friday prayers and *solat jenazah* before burial ^[1].

The cemetery itself is the **Muslim Cemetery** within the **Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Complex**, the only active burial ground in Singapore. It is administered by **NEA**, not MUIS ^[2].

The licensed funeral parlour

Masjid Pusara Aman has an on-site licensed funeral parlour. It is the community fallback for cases without family or where *ghusl* and *solat jenazah* cannot be held at home or a local mosque. Services are provided free of charge ^[1].

The 15-year burial policy

Since 1 November 1998, all graves in Singapore are subject to a 15-year burial period. For Muslims, where re-burial is mandated, exhumed remains are re-interred in smaller individual plots at **Pusara Abadi** or Pusara Aman within the same complex.

The MUIS Fatwa Committee approved the modular concrete crypt system in 2001 as permissible under Islamic law, provided the *lahad* niche is preserved inside the concrete crypt ^[4].

The exhumation programme

NEA exhumes by phases. Affected next-of-kin receive written notification and are engaged before exhumation proceeds. Current information for affected families is at pusara.sg ^[5].

- **Phase 8** (covering graves from 1990 to 2003) was completed in June 2025 ^[3].

- **Phase 10** (covering graves from 2001 to 2009) is current, affecting Muslim Cemetery Blocks 23, 24, 25, 26, N-429, N-1-1, N-1-2 ^[2].

The Tengah Air Base expansion

The Choa Chu Kang Cemetery is being reduced from about 318 hectares to about 200 hectares progressively to accommodate the Tengah Air Base expansion. This will require exhumation of approximately 5,000 Muslim

graves (older graves first) over time. NEA communicates with affected NOK in advance.

The modular crypt system is projected to keep the grounds viable for many decades.

How families typically use Masjid Pusara Aman

- **Solat jenazah** before burial, especially when going straight from the funeral parlour to the cemetery.
- **A quiet rest** for elderly family between the prayer and the burial.
- **Ghusl and kafan** at the on-site licensed parlour, if home space is not available.
- **Coordination** with the cemetery office across the road for the burial slot.

When in doubt

Call **Masjid Pusara Aman** at **6792 9378** or **NEA** at **6225 5632**. For religious coordination, **MUIS** at **6359 1199**.

[1]: Masjid Pusara Aman, About.

[2]: NEA, Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Exhumation Programme.

[3]: NEA, Choa Chu Kang Muslim Cemetery Exhumation Phase 8.

[4]: MUIS Fatwa on Exhumation 2001.

[5]: Pusara.sg, NOK engagement portal.

Transport and logistics

Transport and logistics

The funeral director handles most of this. This page exists so you know what is being arranged for you.

Typical flow

1. **Pickup**: from hospital mortuary or home.

2. **Ghusl and kafan**: at home, at the funeral parlour, or at Masjid Pusara Aman's licensed parlour.
3. **Solat jenazah**: at a mosque, home, or void deck.
4. **Transport to cemetery**: to the Muslim Cemetery within the Choa Chu Kang Cemetery Complex.
5. **Burial**.

Vehicles

- **Hearse van (van jenazah) or hearse bus (bus jenazah)**. All must be LTA-registered.
- **Family bus**, typically 33 to 50 seats, included in most packages ^[1].
- Additional cars at extra cost where needed.

Indicative costs

- **Hospital-to-home transfer alone**: roughly \$100 to \$120, when bought separately.
- **Full Muslim burial package**: typically **\$1,170 to \$1,600** (excluding the \$315 NEA burial fee) ^{[1][2]}. Premium packages run higher.

These are indicative. Confirm current pricing with your provider.

Timing within 24 hours

Islamic practice asks for burial as soon as possible, ideally within 24 hours. NEA's streamlined ePortal process (Permit to Bury online, same-day slot booking) supports this. Logistic delays (Coroner referral, family arriving) sometimes shift the timing.

Repatriation

A. Bringing the deceased TO Singapore

A **Coffin Import Permit** from NEA is required, fee **\$17.50**. A Permit to Bury or Cremate is issued together with it at no extra charge ^[3].

Apply via the [NEA ePortal](#) under Port Health Services. For help, NEA Port Health Office is at 4545 Jalan Bukit Merah, tel **6222 2585**.

Typical documents:

1. Overseas death certificate, English or with certified translation.
2. Coffin sealing certificate, with English translation if needed.
3. Embalming certificate, if embalmed, with English translation if needed.
4. Coffin Export Permit from the origin country.
5. Airway bill.
6. Letter of authorisation if the applicant is not a direct NOK.

The NOK or embassy should inform the Singapore Embassy or Consulate of flight details (date and flight number) so NEA Port Health can coordinate clearance on arrival.

For Singapore citizens dying overseas, report to ICA via FormSG at go.gov.sg/ica-report-overseas-death ^[4].

B. Sending a Singapore Muslim abroad for burial

The funeral director handles embalming (check destination country requirements), coffin preparation, NEA Coffin Export Permit where applicable, airline coordination, and embassy documentation. The receiving country may require a No Objection Certificate from its embassy in Singapore ^[5].

Islamic embalming note: Some Islamic scholars consider embalming contrary to the principle of natural decomposition. If the destination country does not mandate it, a funeral director experienced in Muslim repatriation can often arrange exemptions with airlines. Call MUIS at **6359 1199** for religious advice. The Singapore Funeral Committee maintains an overview of Muslim repatriation logistics for reference ^[5].

When in doubt

Your funeral director is the right first call. NEA Port Health: **6222 2585**. MUIS: **6359 1199**. MFA Singapore consular help is documented in the *Guide for Next of Kin* ^[4].

^[1]: Singapore Muslim Casket and Marble Contractor, Burial fee.

^[2]: Jasa Budi Muslim Casket, Muslim Burial Services.

- [3]. NEA, When death occurs overseas.
- [4]. MFA Singapore, A Guide for Next of Kin.
- [5]. Singapore Funeral Committee, Muslim Repatriation.

After burial

Condolences and visiting (ta'ziyah)

Condolences and visiting (ta'ziyah)

Ta'ziyah is the Islamic act of offering condolences to the bereaved. The Prophet, peace be upon him, encouraged visiting bereaved families to comfort them and to pray for the deceased.

Timing

- The sunnah period for *ta'ziyah* is within **three days** of the death.
- *Ta'ziyah* after three days is also permissible, especially for those travelling or unable to attend earlier ^[3].

What to say

The classical Islamic phrase is:

Inna lillahi wa inna ilayhi raji'un Indeed, we belong to Allah, and to Him we shall return.

You may also say:

- *Allahummaghfir lahu warhamhu*, for a male, "may Allah forgive and have mercy on him."
- *Allahummaghfir laha warhamha*, for a female.
- "May Allah grant the deceased Jannah and give your family *sabr* (patience)."

In English: "I am so sorry for your loss. May Allah make this easy for you. May Allah grant your father Jannah." Simple words are enough. Many people say too much and end up wishing they had said less.

How to visit

- Visit quietly. The bereaved family may be exhausted.

- Do not bring flowers, this is not a Muslim tradition.
- Donations in an envelope are appropriate.
- Bringing food for the family is encouraged; it reduces their burden. Many families prepare nothing in the first three days because visitors bring it.

Mourning periods

- General mourning: three days for non-widow relatives. Mourning beyond three days as a personal experience is normal; organised public displays beyond three days are discouraged ^[4].
- Widow *iddah*: four lunar months and ten days. See [iddah.md](#).
- Loud wailing (*niyahah*) is prohibited in Islam. Quiet tears and gentle grief are accepted.

Receiving condolences at home

The family typically receives visitors at home for three days. Hanafi, some Maliki, and some Hanbali scholars permit gathering to receive condolences for up to three days, conditioned on it being free of objectionable practices and not burdening the bereaved ^[3].

Practical points:

- Designate one or two family members to greet visitors.
- Have water and light refreshments. Visitors may bring food.
- Take breaks. Visitors should not expect the family to be available all hours.
- Limit numbers in the home at any one time, especially if elders or children are present.

If you cannot attend the burial

You may perform *solat al-ghayb*, the funeral prayer in absentia, once *ghusl* has been completed. This is performed facing the qibla, intending the prayer for the specific deceased ^[5]. See [30-fardhu-kifayah/solat-jenazah.md](#).

What to say to children

Use simple, true words. "Grandfather has gone to Allah. We will pray for him.

We will miss him." Avoid frightening metaphors. Children grieve in waves; let them ask questions repeatedly.

When in doubt

Your *imam* is a good first call. MUIS hotline: **6359 1199**.

[3]: IslamQA, Gathering to receive condolences.

[4]: eCondolence, Islam, Periods of Mourning.

[5]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, advisory on funeral prayers (English).

Grief and mental health for Muslims in Singapore

Grief and mental health for Muslims in Singapore

An Islamic frame, briefly

Grief is a natural human experience. The Quran depicts Prophet Yaqub, peace be upon him, grieving deeply over Prophet Yusuf, peace be upon him. *Sabr* (patience) means persevering through loss with trust in Allah, not suppressing emotion. *Redha* (acceptance) recognises that all affairs return to Allah. Both *sabr* and *redha* coexist with tears, sleepless nights, and the slow rebuilding of life ^{[1][2]}.

The Prophet, peace be upon him, wept when his son Ibrahim died, and said, "The eyes shed tears, the heart grieves, and we say only what pleases our Lord."

You are allowed to grieve. You are also allowed to ask for help.

Talking about it is not weak faith

The MUIS *ADIL* module on grief and suffering, and the MUIS-aligned *MuslimSG* articles, explicitly encourage professional help rather than suffering in silence ^{[1][2][3]}. *Sabr* is not silence.

Muslim-affirming counselling and support in Singapore

- **Club HEAL**, a Muslim-focused mental wellness NGO. Founded 2012, IPC charity. Provides psycho-education, supportive counselling, and psychiatric rehabilitation. Five centres across Singapore. Open to all regardless of race or religion. Tel **6899 3463**, Mon to Fri 9am to 5pm ^[4].
- **PERGAS Asatizah Solace Care**, an emotional and spiritual support service run by the asatizah network.
- **Sacred Heartwork**, a private Islamic counselling and therapy hub with licensed Muslim therapists who combine clinical psychology with Islamic principles. Online and in person.
- **AMP Helpline**, for Malay/Muslim families. Tel **6416 3960** or **6416 3961**, Mon to Fri 10am to 5pm.

Singapore mental health helplines

- **National Mindline 1771**, the national 24-hour mental health helpline. Call **1771**, WhatsApp **6669 1771**, webchat at mindline.sg/fsmh ^[5].
- **Samaritans of Singapore (SOS)**, 24-hour crisis line **1767**. CareText (WhatsApp) **9151 1767**.
- **SAMH (Singapore Association for Mental Health)**, toll-free helpline **1800 283 7019**, Mon to Sat 9am to 5pm.
- **Silver Ribbon Singapore**, emotional support and counselling, **6386 1928** ^[6].
- **CHAT (Centre of Excellence for Youth Mental Health)**, for those aged 16 to 30, **6493 6500/1**.

If you are in immediate crisis, call **1767** (SOS) or **995** for ambulance.

What grief tends to look like

- Waves. You will be fine in the morning and undone by something small in the afternoon. This is normal.
- Sleep disturbance. Eat and drink even when you do not want to.
- Anniversaries and prayer times can be hard. Plan a small ritual for those

moments: a du'a, a short visit to the grave (where appropriate), a quiet meal with family.

- Family conflict often surfaces. Grief amplifies what was already there. Be gentle, including with yourself.
- Worry about the deceased's hereafter is common. Continue to make du'a and *sadaqah* on their behalf. The community can also do *istighfar* and *sadaqah* in their name.

When to seek professional help

Consider speaking to a counsellor or doctor if you experience any of the following for more than two weeks:

- Persistent inability to sleep or oversleeping.
- Loss of appetite or significant weight change.
- Inability to function at work or with family.
- Thoughts of self-harm or that life is not worth living.
- Persistent flashbacks if the death was traumatic.

Call **1771** or **1767** if you have thoughts of self-harm. You can also walk into a polyclinic and ask to be seen.

Looking after children

Children grieve in waves and ask the same question many times. Answer truthfully and simply. Maintain routines. Allow them to attend age-appropriate parts of the rituals if they want to. Avoid sending them away. A school counsellor can help.

When in doubt

Call any of the helplines above. For Islamic spiritual support, your *imam* or **MUIS** at **6359 1199**. For professional grief support, **Club HEAL 6899 3463** or **National Mindline 1771**.

[1]: MUIS ADIL, Grief and Suffering in Islam module.

[2]: MuslimSG, Mental health and well-being in Islam.

[3]: MuslimSG, Spirituality and mental well-being in Islam.

[4]: Club HEAL official site.

[5]: MOH, National Mindline 1771 launch.

[6]: Silver Ribbon Singapore.

Iddah for a Muslim widow

Iddah for a Muslim widow

Iddah is the waiting period a Muslim widow observes after the death of her husband. The duration is fixed by the Quran.

Duration

- **4 lunar months and 10 days** from the date of the husband's death ^[1].
- If the widow is pregnant, *iddah* continues until childbirth, whichever is longer ^[1].
- Applies regardless of whether the marriage was consummated, and regardless of the widow's age.

The basis is Surah al-Baqarah 2:234, "They shall wait concerning themselves four months and ten days."

Ihdad (mourning practices during iddah)

During *iddah* the widow observes *ihdad*:

- Does not remarry, and does not enter into a new marriage contract.
- Avoids adorning herself with perfume, kohl, jewellery typically worn for adornment, and bridal-style clothing.
- Generally remains at the home where she was when her husband died. Scholars differ on strictness of movement; the majority view permits leaving the home for necessities (work, medical appointments, shopping for essentials, attending to children's needs).
- Continues normal daily activities, prayer, work where needed, and care of family.

There is no requirement to wear only white or to refuse all visitors. Quiet, dignified mourning is the spirit.

Distinction from divorce *iddah*

- Divorce *iddah* (after revocable *talak*) is three menstrual cycles, or three months for those who do not menstruate.
- Widow *iddah* is four lunar months and ten days. This is longer, to honour the marriage ^[1].

AMLA recognition

The Administration of Muslim Law Act (AMLA) defines *idah* as the period during which a widow is forbidden by Muslim law to remarry. The Syariah Court enforces this in estate and matrimonial proceedings ^{[3][4]}.

Practical questions widows often have

- **Can I work?** Yes, the majority view permits work. Make reasonable adjustments where possible.
- **Can I visit my parents?** Yes, for necessity and short visits; preference is to return to the main home.
- **Can I attend my husband's *tahlil*?** Yes, you can attend gatherings held at the home.
- **Can I receive visitors?** Yes, visitors offering condolences are welcome. Maintain the usual modesty norms.
- **Can I travel for medical care or for emergencies?** Yes, the majority view permits travel for necessity.
- **Do I have to wear specific clothes?** Modest, plain clothing is appropriate. There is no specific colour required by mainstream Singapore practice.

Nafkah and inheritance during *iddah*

The widow continues to be entitled to her share of the estate per *faraid*, in addition to any *wasiat* provision. See [60-inheritance/faraid.md](#) and [60-inheritance/wasiat.md](#).

For *nafkah* (maintenance) during *iddah*, Singapore practitioners can clarify

how AMLA applies to specific cases ^[2].

When in doubt

Ask your *imam*. For legal questions on *iddah* status interacting with marriage applications or estate matters, the Syariah Court of Singapore is the right venue. MUIS hotline: **6359 1199**.

[1]: IRB Law SG, Muslim Divorces, Overview of Iddah.

[2]: IRB Law SG, Nafkah Iddah and Mutaah.

[3]: Singapore Statutes Online, AMLA 1966.

[4]: Syariah Court Singapore.

Tahlil and commemorations

Tahlil and commemorations

This page covers tahlil and the commemorations Muslims in the Nusantara tradition commonly hold on the 3rd, 7th, 40th, and 100th day after death. There is scholarly disagreement here. The mainstream Singapore-MUIS position is presented first, then respected differing views are noted, with a recommendation to consult an *asatizah* for your family.

What tahlil is

A *tahlil* is a gathering of family and community to recite verses from the Quran, *zikir* (remembrances of Allah), and *du'a* for the deceased. Common elements include *Surah Ya-Sin*, *Surah al-Ikhlās*, *Surah al-Falaq*, *Surah al-Nas*, *al-Fatihah*, and the *tahlil* phrase itself (*la ilaha illallah*). It is often led by an *imam* or *ustaz*.

Mainstream Singapore-MUIS position

The Office of the Mufti has not issued a standalone fatwa prohibiting or endorsing fixed-day *tahlil* gatherings. In practice, MUIS treats *tahlil* sessions as a legitimate community practice. During the pandemic, MUIS issued guidance that *regulated* how *tahlil* could be conducted (attendance caps, an

ustaz present), implicitly accepting the practice itself ^{[1][2]}.

This reflects how *tahlil* is embedded in Singapore Malay-Muslim community life as *urf* (accepted custom).

Other respected views

Some classical Shafi'i scholars are cited as having considered scheduled *kenduri arwah* or *tahlilan* gatherings as *bid'ah munkarah*, on the basis that the Prophet, peace be upon him, and the *salaf* did not institute fixed mourning-day rituals. This view is also represented in Wahabi and Salafi-influenced scholarship ^[3].

The Hanafi *fatwa* tradition has cautioned against *gathering for the third or fortieth day* if it includes objectionable practices, while permitting general du'a and Quran recitation for the deceased anytime ^[3]. Some contemporary mufti offices in the region treat commemorative gatherings as permissible local custom where they avoid waste, ostentation, or imposing burdens on the bereaved family ^[4].

Practical etiquette

Whatever your family's chosen approach, the following are commonly observed:

- Invite an *imam* or *ustaz* to lead. They can recite, share short reflections, and lead du'a.
- Keep the gathering short and unburdening. The bereaved family is grieving. Visitors may bring food rather than the family preparing it.
- Avoid wastefulness and ostentation.
- Make the du'a sincere. The benefit of recitation and du'a for the deceased is itself a matter of scholarly *ikhtilaf* (difference of opinion); the dominant Singapore practice holds that it does benefit the deceased.

The 40-day question

The 40th day commemoration is widely practised in Singapore. Stricter views consider fixed-day commemorations as innovations. The Singapore community practice generally accepts them as local custom, with the

conditions above. Ask your *asatizah* if you would like a personal ruling for your family.

Mourning beyond three days

The general Islamic mourning period for relatives other than the spouse is three days. Mourning beyond three days is permitted as a personal emotional experience; organised public displays of grief beyond three days are discouraged. The *iddah* for a widow is different and longer; see [iddah.md](#).

Loud wailing (*niyahah*) is prohibited in Islam. Quiet tears and gentle expressions of grief are accepted.

When in doubt

Ask your *imam* or call MUIS at **6359 1199**. For deeper fiqh questions, the Office of the Mufti is at muis.gov.sg/officeofthemufti. This page is not a fatwa.

[1]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, COVID-19 funeral advisory (English).

[2]: MUIS Office of the Mufti, advisory on funeral prayers during Phase 2 (English).

[3]: IslamQA Hanafi, Three-day and forty-day gatherings.

[4]: Jabatan Mufti Wilayah Persekutuan, Irsyad al-Fatwa 201.

Inheritance

Faraid, Islamic inheritance shares

Faraid, Islamic inheritance shares

Faraid is the Islamic system of fixed inheritance shares. For Muslims domiciled in Singapore who died after 1 July 1968, AMLA section 111 makes faraid mandatory. The default school is **Shafi'i** unless the deceased clearly adhered to another madhab ^[1].

The two heir categories

1. **Quranic heirs (Ashabul Furud)** receive fixed Quranic fractions: husband, wife, daughter, father, mother, paternal grandfather, grandmother, sister, consanguine sister, uterine siblings, and others.
2. **Agnatic heirs (Asabah)** receive the residue: son, father (residue after his fixed 1/6), brother, paternal uncle, and others ^{[1][2]}.

Illustrative shares (Shafi'i)

The actual share depends on which heirs are alive at the time of death. The table below is illustrative.

Heir	When no children present	When children present
Husband	1/2	1/4
Wife (one or up to four wives)	1/4 (shared)	1/8 (shared)
Father	Residue, plus 1/6 if children present	1/6 plus residue if only daughters
Mother	1/3	1/6

Heir	When no children present	When children present
One daughter (no son)	1/2	n/a
Two or more daughters (no son)	2/3 shared	n/a
Son and daughter together	Residue; son = 2x daughter's share	n/a

For precise calculation in your family situation, use the **Syariah Court's online calculator**, accessible via the MUIS faraid page ^[3]. The Syariah Court's *Faraidh* brochure has detailed tables ^[2].

Key exclusions from faraid

- **Non-Muslim heirs** do not inherit by faraid. A wasiat (within the 1/3 limit) is the route to provide for them. See wasiat.md.
- **Adopted children** are not blood relatives and do not inherit by faraid. A wasiat or a *hibah* can provide for them. See hibah-and-nuzriah.md.
- **Illegitimate children** cannot inherit from the father's estate. They may inherit from the mother's estate.
- **Heirs who predecease the deceased** do not pass their share to their own children automatically. There is no rule of representation under classical faraid. A Deed of Family Undertaking, wasiat provision, or *hibah* during lifetime are how families address this.

What if no faraid heirs survive

If no faraid heirs survive, or there is a residue with no agnatic heir, the remainder goes to **BaitulMal**, administered by MUIS. The Syariah Court guidance addresses this scenario ^[1].

How distribution actually happens

1. Pay the debts of the deceased first (including burial costs, outstanding bills, and debts to others).
2. Execute any valid **wasiat** up to the 1/3 limit (subject to the rules in

wasiat.md).

3. Distribute the remainder by faraid, as certified in the **Inheritance Certificate** issued by the Syariah Court. See [syariah-court-inheritance-certificate.md](#).

Practical tips

- Have an open family conversation about who the heirs are.
- Apply for the **Inheritance Certificate** early; it is the first step before Probate or Letters of Administration at the Family Justice Courts.
- For complex estates (foreign property, business interests, blended families), engage a Syariah-experienced lawyer.

When in doubt

For calculation, the Syariah Court online calculator. For complex cases, a Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer. For religious questions, MUIS at **6359 1199**.

[1]: Syariah Court, Inheritance Overview.

[2]: Syariah Court Faraidh Brochure.

[3]: MUIS Faraid page.

Hibah and nuzriah

Hibah and nuzriah

This page covers the lifetime gifts (*hibah*) and conditional gifts (*nuzriah*) that Muslims in Singapore can use alongside (and outside of) *wasiat* and *faraid*. The legal picture changed materially with the 2019 MUIS joint tenancy fatwa.

Hibah (lifetime gift)

A *hibah* is a gift made during the donor's lifetime. For a *hibah* to be valid in classical Islamic law:

- The donor is alive and of sound mind.

- Unlike *wasiat*, *hibah* is **not capped at 1/3** and can be made to faraid heirs. If the donor dies before *qabdh* (possession) completes, the *hibah* may be contested. In the modern CPF and insurance context, MUIS has issued specific fatwas permitting deferred-possession *hibah*; see [joint-accounts-cpf-insurance.md](#).

Nuzriah (conditional gift)

A *nuzriah* is a vow to give property to a specified person upon a condition, typically the death of the donor. It requires a specific pronouncement (*sighah*).

Post the 2019 MUIS joint tenancy fatwa, **separate nuzriah documents for HDB flats held under joint tenancy are no longer recommended**. The right of survivorship under civil law is now accepted by MUIS as the operative mechanism for joint tenancy, without the need for an additional *nuzriah* or *hibah ruqba* document ^[1].

Hibah ruqba

Hibah ruqba is a gift conditional on survivorship: "if I die before you, this is yours." It was used alongside HDB joint tenancy documents prior to the 2019 fatwa revision. The 2019 fatwa retired its routine use for HDB joint tenancy.

SNTC Hibah (Special Needs Trust Company)

The MUIS Fatwa Committee approved a Special Needs Trust Company (SNTC) trust as a form of *hibah amanah khas* (special trust *hibah*) for caregivers of persons with disabilities. The SNTC trust falls outside *faraid* distribution rules, allowing parents and caregivers to provide for a child with disabilities beyond the limits of *faraid* ^[2].

This is a specialised path. SNTC operates under the National Council of Social Service framework. Speak to SNTC directly and to a Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer if this applies to your family.

When to use hibah vs wasiat

- **Wasiat** is for after death, capped at 1/3 of the net estate, and only to non-faraid heirs. See [wasiat.md](#).

- **Hibah** is during your lifetime, not capped, and can go to faraid heirs as well as anyone else. Once the gift is complete, the property is no longer yours.

A common pattern is to use hibah for a specific intended provision during your lifetime (a property for a child with disabilities, support for a non-Muslim parent), while using wasiat for legacy provisions (charity, specific bequests within 1/3).

Practical points

- Document the hibah in writing. While verbal gifts can be valid in Islamic law, written documentation prevents disputes.
- For real property and significant assets, use a Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer.
- Confirm that *qabdh* (possession) has actually transferred. Otherwise the hibah may be challenged.

When in doubt

For complex estates, a Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer. For religious questions, MUIS at **6359 1199**. For the joint tenancy fatwa, see the full text ^[1].

^[1]: MUIS Joint Tenancy Fatwa 2019.

^[2]: MUIS Hibah SNTC Fatwa.

Joint accounts, CPF, and insurance for Muslims

Joint accounts, CPF, and insurance for Muslims

This page maps four asset types onto the Muslim inheritance framework in Singapore: HDB ownership, joint bank accounts, CPF, and insurance.

HDB joint tenancy

Under **joint tenancy**, co-owners collectively own the whole flat. On one owner's death, the **right of survivorship** operates: ownership passes automatically to the surviving co-owner(s), regardless of any *wasiat* or *faraid* rules ^{[1][7]}.

The Singapore Court of Appeal confirmed this in *Shafeeg bin Salim Talib v Fatimah bte Abud*: the Land Titles Act applies to Muslims, and the right of survivorship is a civil law mechanism, not a Muslim law rule ^[6].

The **2019 MUIS Joint Tenancy Fatwa** affirmed that the right of survivorship applies to joint tenancy and validated this outcome under Islamic law. Separate *nuzriah* or *hibah ruqba* documents are **no longer required or recommended** ^[2].

If the surviving joint tenant wishes to respect *faraid* outcomes, MUIS advises an amicable conversation with the other beneficiaries, potentially via a Deed of Family Undertaking.

HDB tenancy-in-common

Under **tenancy-in-common**, each co-owner holds a separate, defined share (for example 60/40). On death, the deceased co-owner's share **falls into the estate** and is distributed per *wasiat* or *faraid*. The flat may need to be sold so the deceased's share can be liquidated for distribution.

Practical guidance: choose tenancy-in-common if the intention is to distribute the share according to *faraid*. Choose joint tenancy where survivorship to the co-owner is the intended outcome ^[1].

Joint bank accounts

On one account holder's death, the surviving holder typically retains access under the account's contractual terms (joint and several). The deceased's interest may technically form part of the estate, but banks usually release funds to the survivor in practice.

There is no published MUIS fatwa specifically on joint bank accounts. Families with disputes should consult a Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer.

CPF nomination

CPF savings are excluded from the estate for the purposes of *wasiat* and *faraid* distribution. They are handled by a separate **CPF nomination** under the CPF Act ^[3].

History of MUIS positions:

- **1971 fatwa:** CPF monies were treated as part of the estate. The nominee was a trustee obliged to distribute per *faraid*.
- **2010 fatwa (current):** CPF nomination is reclassified as a contemporary form of *hibah*. Because CPF Act restrictions prevent physical transfer during the contributor's lifetime (*qabdh* is not completed in the classical sense), the nomination is treated as a binding intention and promise of gift. Nominated CPF monies go **directly to the nominee** and do **not** need to be distributed by *faraid* ^[3].

Practical implications:

- A contributor may nominate, or rely on the default (no nomination = paid to the Public Trustee, distributed per *faraid* via the Inheritance Certificate), or combine both.
- A nomination made with the deliberate intent to deny the rights of *faraid* heirs is not permitted under Islamic ethics, even if it is legally valid under the CPF Act. Contributors should consider the financial welfare of all dependants ^[3].

Insurance nominations

Singapore's Insurance Act (as amended from 1 September 2009) provides two nomination types for life policies and accident and health policies with death benefits.

Trust nomination (irrevocable)

- Policyholder nominates spouse, children, or both as beneficiaries and **creates a trust** of the policy moneys.
- The policyholder loses all ownership rights in the policy on nomination.
- Revocation requires written consent of all nominees.
- AMLA section 111(1)(b) exempts Insurance Act provisions from the Muslim will restrictions, so trust nominations are valid for Muslims.

- The 2007 MUIS fatwa accepts trust/irrevocable nominations as classical *hibah* ^[4].

Revocable nomination

- Policyholder can nominate any person (not restricted to spouse and children), and may change nominees freely without consent.
- The **2012 MUIS fatwa** treats revocable insurance nomination as equivalent to CPF nomination: a contemporary form of *hibah*, permissible. The nominee's right arises only on the policyholder's death, the nomination is revocable during lifetime, and it fulfils the spirit of caring for dependants ^[4].

Both trust and revocable nominations result in death benefits passing **outside the estate**, not subject to *faraid* distribution.

Dependants' Protection Scheme (DPS)

The **2023 MUIS DPS fatwa** confirms that a nominated DPS assured sum is the absolute right of the nominee, not part of the estate, and not subject to *faraid*. Non-nominated DPS sums fall into the estate and are distributed per *faraid* ^[5].

Practical action list

- Review your HDB ownership type (joint tenancy vs tenancy-in-common). Decide deliberately, not by default.
- Make a CPF nomination, even if it is conservative.
- Make insurance nominations on each life policy.
- Tell your family where these documents and account details are kept.
- Talk to a Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer for complex estates.

When in doubt

A Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer for the legal side. MUIS at **6359 1199** for the religious side. The full fatwa texts are linked above.

^[1]: MUIS, Home Ownership.

^[2]: MUIS Joint Tenancy Fatwa 2019.

^[3]: MUIS CPF Nomination Fatwa.

[4]: MUIS Revocable Insurance Nomination Fatwa.

[5]: MUIS Dependants Protection Scheme Fatwa.

[6]: SingaporeLegalAdvice, Muslim Inheritance Law.

[7]: HDB, Living in an HDB Flat.

Syariah Court Inheritance Certificate walkthrough

Syariah Court Inheritance Certificate

The **Inheritance Certificate (IC)** is the mandatory first step before applying for a Grant of Probate (where a *wasiat* exists) or Letters of Administration (intestate) at the Family Justice Courts.

What it does

The IC lists the lawful heirs and their faraid shares for the deceased Muslim's estate. The Syariah Court issues it based on facts provided by the applicant. The Court does not hear evidence or make factual findings; the applicant bears responsibility for accuracy ^[1].

Who can apply

Any family member of the deceased may apply. Lawyers, the Office of the Public Trustee, and MUIS can also apply on behalf of others using *CorpPass* ^[1].

How to apply

1. Visit the **SYC Portal** at syariahcourt.gov.sg and log in with **SingPass** (individuals) or **CorpPass** (firms, agencies). Foreign applicants without SingPass may apply for a **SYCPass**.
2. Submit the online application. Processing is within **7 days** of each submission ^[1].
3. Validity window: **60 days** from the original submission date. If the

application is returned as "Incomplete", resubmit within 7 days of the remarks.

4. Once approved, download the **Statutory Declaration (SD)** template from your dashboard, complete it, and affirm it before a **Commissioner for Oaths**.

5. Upload the affirmed SD. After verification, the IC is issued in **downloadable PDF format** via the portal.

6. For ICs issued after 23 July 2025, there is no time limit on download. For ICs issued on or before 23 July 2025, the download window was 14 days ^[1].

Fees (SGD)

Item	Fee
Application for Inheritance Certificate	\$34.00
Application for Extract of Inheritance Certificate	\$34.00
Revision of Inheritance Certificate (per page)	\$34.00

Payment by PayNow or eNETS or credit card, at least 1 day before the 60-day validity expires ^[2].

Documents typically needed

- Death certificate (the digital one downloaded from My Legacy is fine).
- Deceased's NRIC, FIN, or passport.
- Family particulars of all potential heirs: NRIC or identification, relationship to the deceased.

The portal walks the applicant through the required fields. The Syariah Court does not publish a rigid document list because circumstances vary.

After the IC

- If there is a *wasiat*, file for a **Grant of Probate** at the Family Justice Courts.

- If there is no *wasiat*, file for **Letters of Administration** at the Family Justice Courts.
- Submit the IC together with the application.

Documents to gather before you apply

The portal walks you through required fields, but having these ready makes the process much faster ^[1].

- Digital death certificate (downloaded from My Legacy).
- Deceased's NRIC, FIN, or passport (front and back).
- Deceased's marriage certificate (or divorce certificate where relevant).
- NRIC / birth certificates of all surviving children, including step-children where applicable.
- NRIC of surviving spouse (or each surviving spouse if there are multiple).
- Identification of surviving parents, where they survive the deceased.
- Identification of surviving siblings, where they are relevant heirs (depends on family structure).
- A list of the deceased's assets (HDB or private property, bank accounts, CPF, insurance policies, shares, vehicles, jewellery). The IC itself does not list assets, but you will need this when you go to each institution afterward.
- A list of the deceased's debts (mortgage, personal loans, credit cards, family loans).
- Any *wasiat* (Islamic will) that exists.

What if a beneficiary is overseas

Overseas beneficiaries can still be named in the application. You will need their full name, identification number, and relationship to the deceased. The Court does not require them to attend in person for the IC stage.

Later, at the **probate or Letters of Administration** stage at the Family Justice Courts, overseas beneficiaries may need to issue a **Letter of Authorisation** to a representative in Singapore. Consult a Syariah-experienced lawyer for this.

The actual distribution to the minor is held in trust until they reach the age of majority. At the probate or LA stage, the Family Justice Courts may require additional steps such as appointing a trustee for the minor's share.

Consult a Syariah-experienced lawyer if minors are involved, especially where there is property or large CPF/insurance amounts to manage.

How the IC is used afterward

The IC is the document the institutions below need to release the deceased's assets to the heirs per *faraid*. Bring a **printout of the IC** plus the **digital death certificate** to each of the following:

- **Banks:** present at the branch where the deceased held accounts. The bank will require account closure forms, identification of each heir, and may require a Grant of Probate or Letters of Administration for larger balances.
- **CPF Board:** if there is no CPF nomination, the CPF Board pays to the Public Trustee, who distributes per the IC shares. If a nomination exists, it overrides *faraid* (see `joint-accounts-cpf-insurance.md`).
- **HDB:** for transferring ownership of a flat held under tenancy-in-common into the heirs' names. Joint tenancy flats pass by survivorship to the surviving co-owner and do not require the IC.
- **Insurance companies:** for un-nominated policies; payout follows the IC. Nominated policies follow the nomination.
- **Stockbrokers and CDP:** present the IC and the LA to transfer share holdings.
- **Vehicle ownership transfers (LTA):** present the IC and the death certificate to transfer the vehicle to an heir.

Common rejection reasons

Based on the Syariah Court's published guidance and practitioner notes ^[1]:

- Missing children or step-children in the heir list.
- Incorrect or unclear relationship descriptions (for example, mixing maternal and paternal lineages).
- Mismatched names between the death certificate and the deceased's NRIC
Minor beneficiaries are included in the IC by their parent or legal guardian.

(especially common where names include particles like *bin*, *binti*, *abdul*).

- Missing documentation for an overseas spouse or child.
- Not including the deceased's parents when they are alive (parents are faraid heirs).

If the application is returned as "Incomplete", you have **7 days** from the remarks to resubmit. The 60-day overall validity window continues to run from the original submission ^[1].

Quick numbers

- Application fee: **\$34**, payable by PayNow, eNETS, or credit card ^[2].
- Processing time: **7 days** per submission.
- Validity: **60 days** from first submission to download the issued IC.
- For ICs issued after 23 July 2025: no time limit on download. Older ICs had a 14-day download window ^[1].

Common questions

- **Can I apply if I am not the spouse or child?** Yes, any family member with the required information can apply. Confirm with a lawyer for complex situations.
- **Can I apply if some heirs are overseas?** Yes. Provide their particulars in the application; physical presence is not required for the IC.
- **What if I am not sure who all the heirs are?** The Court relies on the applicant's stated facts. If you are uncertain, consult a Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer before applying.
- **Can I revise the IC if I missed an heir?** Yes, the revision fee is \$34.00 per page ^[2].
- **Do I need a lawyer?** Not always. Many families self-file. For complex estates (foreign property, multiple marriages, blended family, business interests, large CPF or insurance amounts, minor heirs), consult a Syariah-experienced lawyer.

Interactive walkthrough

If you would like a step-by-step interactive checklist, run:

```
python rag/walkthroughs/inheritance_certificate.py
```

or from inside the chat:

```
/walkthrough inheritance-cert
```

The walkthrough asks short yes/no questions and prints a tailored documents checklist and next-step list you can take to the Syariah Court counter.

When in doubt

For application support, the Syariah Court Registry. For complex estates, a Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer. For religious questions, MUIS at **6359 1199**.

[1]: Syariah Court, Application for Inheritance Certificate.

[2]: Syariah Court, Inheritance Fees.

Wasiat, the Islamic will

Wasiat, the Islamic will

A *wasiat* is a Muslim will. It is governed by the Administration of Muslim Law Act (AMLA) section 111, which overrides the Wills Act for Muslims domiciled in Singapore who died after 1 July 1968 [2].

What a wasiat can do

- Bequeath up to **one third (1/3) of the net estate** (after debts) [1][4].
- The bequest must go to someone who is **not already a faraid heir** (the people who receive fixed shares under Islamic inheritance). It can go to non-Muslim relatives, adopted children, friends, charities, or any permissible cause [1][5].
- It can name the executor.

What a wasiat cannot do

- It cannot exceed one third without the consent of all faraid heirs.
- It cannot redirect to existing faraid heirs (they receive their fixed shares regardless).
- It cannot dispose of **CPF savings**, which pass by CPF nomination. See `joint-accounts-cpf-insurance.md`.
- It cannot dispose of assets held under **joint tenancy**, which pass by right of survivorship. See `joint-accounts-cpf-insurance.md`.
- It cannot redirect **nominated insurance payouts**, which pass directly to the named beneficiaries ^[5].

Validity (Shafi'i school)

For a wasiat to be valid in Singapore:

- Testator is a Muslim, at least 21 years old, of sound mind.
- Signed in the presence of **two adult male Muslim witnesses** who are not faraid heirs, not beneficiaries of the wasiat, and not the spouses of the beneficiaries ^[1].
- The executor is legally capable.
- The wasiat is for a purpose permissible under Islamic law.

How to make a wasiat

1. Take stock of your estate: property, CPF, insurance, bank accounts, business interests, debts owed to and by you.
 2. Decide what you would like to bequeath via wasiat, within the 1/3 limit, and to whom.
 3. Engage a Singapore lawyer experienced in Syariah inheritance to draft the document. MUIS encourages this for complex estates ^[1].
 4. Sign in the presence of two qualifying witnesses.
 5. Store the original safely. Tell your executor where it is. Update if circumstances change (new dependants, large changes in assets).
- To amend the wasiat materially, execute a new one that explicitly revokes the prior version, and destroy the old copy.

Without a wasiat

Without a wasiat, the estate is distributed entirely by *faraid* via Letters of Administration. The Intestate Succession Act does **not** apply to Muslims ^[4].

MUIS Wasiat services

MUIS provides guidance and resources on its website. It encourages consultation with a lawyer experienced in Syariah law for complex estates. MUIS does not provide a standard wasiat drafting service; lawyers handle drafting ^[1].

Things to think about

- Have you cared for the children of a deceased sibling, or for an adopted child? Faraid does not cover them. Wasiat (within the 1/3) and *hibah* (during your lifetime) can. See [hibah-and-nuzriah.md](#).
- Have you supported a non-Muslim parent or relative? Faraid excludes them. Wasiat is the route.
- Have you committed to a charity? Wasiat can fund it within the 1/3.

When in doubt

For drafting, a Singapore Syariah-experienced lawyer. For religious questions, MUIS at **6359 1199** or the Office of the Mufti.

^[1]: MUIS Wasiat page.

^[2]: AMLA section 111 (Singapore Statutes Online).

^[4]: SingaporeLegalAdvice, Muslim Inheritance Law.

^[5]: Dentons Rodyk, The Subtle Art of Gifting.

Financial and community

AIC caregiving and bereavement support

AIC caregiving and bereavement support

The **Agency for Integrated Care (AIC)** is Singapore's primary government agency for community and elder care. AIC connects families to financial support, care services, and bereavement resources. It operates under the Ministry of Health ^[1].

When death occurs

AIC maintains a "When Death Occurs" page listing grief support services by provider and target group. Services include Assisi Hospice Grief & Bereavement Care, Counselling and Care Centre, SAGE Counselling Centre (for bereaved seniors aged 50+), O'Joy Care Services (ages 18 to 49), and Viriya Community Services. The list is updated periodically ^[2].

Home-Based Respite Care (HBRC)

Short-term in-home support for caregivers whose loved ones are on home palliative care. Up to 30 single shifts for palliative cases, or 14 consecutive days for compassionate discharge. Apply via the home palliative care provider or an **AIC Link** ^[3].

Caregivers Training Grant

Subsidised training for family caregivers, helping with techniques and emotional resilience.

Home Caregiving Grant

Monthly cash payout for families caring for seniors or persons with disabilities. Eligibility and amounts evolve; check the AIC site for current values.

AIC and the **Social Service Offices (SSO / ComCare)** work in parallel. AIC focuses on community care and elder services. SSO/ComCare handles means-tested financial assistance for living expenses. Bereaved families with financial hardship should approach both, since they cover different gaps.

How to start

- **AIC Hotline: 1800 650 6060**, Mon to Fri 8:30am to 8:30pm, Sat 8:30am to 4pm.
- Visit an **AIC Link** in person, often co-located with a hospital or a polyclinic.
- Call your nearest **Social Service Office (SSO)** for ComCare.

During palliative care

If your loved one is receiving home palliative care:

- Ask the home care provider about HBRC.
- Ask about caregiver training and caregiver mental health resources.
- Get the funeral director's contact in advance, so the family is not searching at 2am.

After death

- Use AIC's "When Death Occurs" page to find a grief service that fits the bereaved person's age and needs ^[2].
- For Muslim-affirming counselling, see [grief-and-mental-health.md](#).

When in doubt

AIC Hotline: **1800 650 6060**. SSO ComCare: see your nearest SSO via supportgowhere.life.gov.sg. MUIS: **6359 1199**.

^[1]: AIC homepage.

^[2]: AIC, When Death Occurs.

^[3]: AIC, Home-Based Respite Care.

AMP, PERGAS, and MENDAKI

AMP, PERGAS, and MENDAKI

These three Singapore organisations serve the Malay/Muslim community in different ways. They are useful in bereavement and afterward.

AMP (Association of Muslim Professionals)

- **AMP Helpline: 6416 3960 or 6416 3961**, Mon to Fri 10am to 5pm. Emotional support, non-judgmental listening. A first port of call for Malay/Muslim families in distress ^[1].
- **Ready for School (RFS) Fund / AMP Education Bursary**: Monetary assistance for diploma and degree students from less-privileged families. Open to all races at local polytechnics, universities, and recognised private institutions ^[2].
- **Singapore Muslim Education Fund (SMEF) Medicine Scholarship**: For Malay/Muslim Singapore citizens pursuing medicine overseas.
- **Counselling and casework**: Includes court-mandated family violence counselling and Syariah Court-referred marriage counselling ^[3].
- **INSPIRASI@AMP**: Post-marriage support, including counselling, casework, and referrals.

AMP does not operate a dedicated bereavement financial assistance scheme; families facing financial hardship are typically referred to MUIS zakat, SSO ComCare, and other schemes.

MENDAKI (Yayasan MENDAKI)

- Primarily education-focused.
- Schemes include **Special Malay Bursary**, **Tertiary Tuition Fee Subsidy (TTFS)**, study loans for local and overseas degree programmes ^[4].
- Apply via the **MyMENDAKI portal** at my.mendaki.org.sg.
- Not a direct bereavement financial assistance scheme, but a surviving parent or guardian may apply for student assistance for dependent children.

PERGAS (Singapore Islamic Scholars and Religious

Teachers Association)

- **Asatizah Financial Assistance (AFA)**: Monthly aid for asatizah with low income or chronic illness.
- **Madrasah Students Adoption Scheme (MSAS)**: Assists full-time madrasah students annually with monthly fees.
- **Ibnu Sabil Assistance Scheme (ISAS)**: For needy Singaporean students pursuing religious studies overseas.
- **Asatizah Solace Care**: Emotional and spiritual support for the community via the asatizah network. Referenced alongside Club HEAL as a Muslim-affirming resource ^[5]^[6].
- PERGAS has been an official zakat collection centre since 2001.

When to call who

- Immediate emotional support, in Malay or English: **AMP Helpline 6416 3960**.
- Financial assistance: **MUIS** at **6359 1199**, then your mosque's Social Development Officer.
- Education assistance for the surviving children: **MyMENDAKI** portal.
- Spiritual support: your local mosque, or **PERGAS Asatizah Solace Care**, or **Club HEAL** at **6899 3463** for Muslim-affirming counselling. See grief-and-mental-health.md.

^[1]: AMP, Helpline.

^[2]: AMP, Students and Education schemes.

^[3]: AMP, Families and counselling.

^[4]: MENDAKI, Assistance portal.

^[5]: PERGAS, Zakat, Donations and Welfare.

^[6]: PERGAS, About.

Employer bereavement leave in Singapore

Employer bereavement leave in Singapore

Bereavement leave is **not** a statutory entitlement under the Employment Act. The Ministry of Manpower does not prescribe the number of days, eligibility, or documentation. Each employer's contract or HR policy applies ^{[1][2]}.

Common practice

Relationship	Typical paid leave
Spouse, child, parent	3 to 5 days
Sibling, parent-in-law	2 to 3 days
Grandparent	1 to 2 days
Extended family	1 to 2 days, or discretionary

These are common ranges, not entitlements ^{[3][4][5]}. Civil servants generally receive 3 days compassionate leave for immediate family. Multinational companies often offer 5 to 7 days; small and medium enterprises may offer fewer.

What to do at work

- Tell your manager or HR as soon as you reasonably can.
- Reference your employment contract or staff handbook for the policy.
- If your policy does not cover the relationship or the number of days, ask if you can use annual leave or unpaid leave.
- Note that Singapore office workers commonly attend *tahlil* gatherings or funeral arrangements over several evenings. Flexible work or staggered leave can help.

Tripartite standards context

The Tripartite Standard on Unpaid Leave for Unexpected Care Needs covers unpaid leave for hospitalisation of immediate family (up to two weeks per year) and care of very young children. It does not mandate bereavement leave. Compassionate leave is listed as an example of an enhanced leave benefit that progressive employers may voluntarily offer ^{[1][2]}.

Muslim-specific considerations

- *Solat jenazah*, burial, *tahlil*, and the iddah of a widow may require additional time off. A short conversation with HR about your needs is reasonable.
- For widows, *iddah* is 4 months 10 days; it does not require quitting work, but reasonable adjustments help. See 50-after-burial/iddah.md.
- Friday *Jumah* attendance often becomes more important in the weeks after a death.

Documentation

Employers may ask for documentation. The digital death certificate from *My Legacy* is acceptable in most cases. The funeral programme or *imam* contact can also be supplied.

When in doubt

Speak to your HR. If you need help interpreting your contract, contact TAFEP at tal.sg/tafep ^[1].

[1]: TAFEP, Caregiving Leave in Singapore.

[2]: Made For Families, Tripartite Guidelines and Standards.

[3]: QuickHR, Compassionate Leave in Singapore 2026 guide.

[4]: Singapore Funeral Care, Bereavement Leave guide.

[5]: Jobstreet SG, Compassionate leave guide.

Mosque-level zakat assistance for the bereaved

Mosque-level zakat assistance for the bereaved

After a death in the family, mosques are often the closest, most practical first stop for help, both spiritual and material.

How to find your nearest Social Development Mosque

The list of Social Development Mosques is at zakat.sg. Most Singapore mosques have a Social Development Officer or equivalent contact for financial assistance enquiries ^[1].

Call the mosque office during regular hours. Explain your situation briefly. Ask for an appointment with the Social Development Officer.

What to bring

- Your NRIC.
- The deceased's death certificate (digital download from My Legacy is fine).
- Proof of income or unemployment.
- Proof of significant expenses (rent, utilities, medical bills).
- Any documentation of dependants (children, elderly parents).
- Any documentation of medical condition or disability.

What the mosque can do

- Initiate an application for MUIS zakat assistance.
- Connect you with the local community's *sadaqah* fund or *bantuan* programme, where available.
- Coordinate volunteers, such as a *tahlil* group or visit from an *ustaz*.
- Refer to AMP counselling, AIC, Club HEAL, or SSO ComCare as appropriate.

What the mosque cannot do

- Issue a binding fatwa for your specific case (the Office of the Mufti does that).
- Override the Syariah Court on inheritance matters.
- Replace ComCare or SSO for national financial assistance.

Why mosque-level matters

The Social Development Officer knows the area. They know which local volunteers are available. They have seen many families through this. A

20-minute conversation in person can save weeks of guessing online.

Scam alert

MUIS issued a public scam alert on 1 March 2025: there are fake online zakat assistance application adverts. Only the in-person mosque process is valid for MUIS zakat assistance. Do not enter personal or banking information into unofficial sites ^[3].

When in doubt

Call your nearest mosque office and ask for the Social Development Officer. MUIS hotline: **6359 1199**.

^[1]: Zakat SG portal.

^[3]: MUIS scam alert on fake online zakat applications.

MUIS zakat and financial assistance

MUIS zakat and financial assistance

For Muslims in Singapore facing financial difficulty after a death, MUIS-administered zakat assistance can provide monthly cash support and one-off help, alongside national schemes like ComCare.

How to apply

Applications **must be made in person** at a **Social Development Mosque** near your home, with a Social Development Officer. MUIS does **not** process zakat assistance online. Beware of scam adverts claiming online applications exist; MUIS issued a scam alert on 1 March 2025 ^[1].

To start:

1. Call **MUIS Hotline 6359 1199** (Mon to Fri 8:30am to 5:30pm) or visit [zakat.sg](https://www.zakat.sg) for the current list of Social Development Mosques.
2. Make an appointment with the nearest Social Development Officer.
3. Bring identification, proof of income (or unemployment), proof of

expenses, and any medical or dependency information that supports your application.

Eligibility (Muslim Singapore Citizen or PR)

Common criteria include:

- Monthly **per capita income (PCI)** below **\$350** (total household gross income divided by number of members).
- Chronic illness, kidney failure, physical or mental disability.
- Head of family currently incarcerated.
- Single parent in need of support ^[2].

Criteria evolve. Confirm current eligibility with the Social Development Officer.

Types of assistance

- Monthly cash assistance.
- One-off assistance for specific needs.
- Possible referrals to other services (counselling, family support, AIC for caregiving).

Mosque-level schemes

Individual mosques administer applications locally. Masjid Darul Makmur, for example, publishes its financial applications page online; other mosques operate similarly ^[3]. Contact your nearest mosque office to ask what they handle.

Other Muslim community funds

The **Muhammadiyah Association** provides zakat and food distribution to Muslim households with PCI of around \$800 or below; applications follow an annual cycle via muhammadiyah.org.sg ^[4].

Things to know

- MUIS zakat is designed to **complement** national schemes like ComCare; applicants are encouraged to approach the **Social Service Office (SSO)** for

ComCare too. The two work in parallel.

- The Social Development Officer is your project manager for assistance. Treat them as a real point of contact, not a form-stamper.
- Documentation matters. The more accurate and current your information, the faster the process.

When in doubt

MUIS hotline: **6359 1199**. Call your nearest mosque office and ask for the Social Development Officer.

[1]: MUIS, Clarification on fake online zakat applications.

[2]: Zakat SG, official MUIS zakat portal.

[3]: Masjid Darul Makmur, Financial Assistance.

[4]: Muhammadiyah Association, Beneficiary Form 2026.

Directory

Singapore contact list for Muslim families in bereavement

Singapore contact list for Muslim families in bereavement

Verify before calling. These numbers change. Last verified: **2026-05-23**. Every entry below is sourced from a public page; the URL is in the Notes column.

This is not exhaustive. For mosques, see `mosques.json` and the per-mosque files in `corpus/80-directory/mosques/`.

Emergency and crisis

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
Ambulance / Fire	995	scdf.gov.sg	National emergency number.
Police	999	police.gov.sg	National emergency number.
Samaritans of Singapore (SOS)	1767	sos.org.sg	24-hour suicide prevention and crisis line.

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
National Mindline	1771	mindline.sg/fsmh	24-hour national mental health helpline (launched 18 Jun 2025). WhatsApp 6669 1771.

Islamic religious coordination

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
MUIS mainline	6359 1199	muissg.gov.sg/contact-us	Mon to Fri 8:30am to 5:30pm; closed 12:30pm to 2:30pm on Fri.

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
MUIS Office of the Mufti	via muissg.gov.sg/officeofthemufti	muissg.gov.sg/officeofthemufti	For fatwa, irsyad, and religious rulings. Email via the main MUIS hotline.
MUIS Tabung Amil and zakat assistance	6359 1199 (route to Social Development)	zakat.sg	Applications in person only at a Social Development Mosque.
MUIS Islamic Legacy Planning (Wasiat, Faraid)	via MUIS hotline	muissg.gov.sg/get-help/islamic-legacy-planning	Hub for wasiat, faraid, home ownership, CPF nominations.

Burial booking and cemetery

Death registration and digital death certificate

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
ICA / My Legacy assistance hotline	6589 8707	ica.gov.sg / death registration	24-hour assistance for those unable to navigate online.
My Legacy portal	online	mylegacy.life.gov.sg	Digital death certificate download (within 30 days of death, free).
ICA report overseas death	online	go.gov.sg/ica-report-overseas-death	For Singapore citizens dying abroad.

Public hospitals general enquiry lines

Numbers below are general enquiry lines. Use the appropriate ward or department line for clinical matters. Verified against each hospital's public contact page.

Hospital	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
National University Hospital (NUH)	6779 5555	nuh.com.sg / contact	General enquiries.
Tan Tock Seng Hospital (TTSH)	6256 6011	ttsh.com.sg / general-information	General enquiries.
Singapore General Hospital (SGH)	6222 3322	sgh.com.sg	General enquiries.
Kho Teck Puat Hospital (KTPH)	6555 8000	ktph.com.sg	General enquiries.
Changi General Hospital (CGH)	6788 8833	cgh.com.sg	General enquiries.
Ng Teng Fong General Hospital (NTFGH)	6716 2000	ntfgh.com.sg	General enquiries.
Sengkang General Hospital (SKH)	6930 6000	skh.com.sg	General enquiries.
KK Women's and Children's Hospital (KKH)	6225 5554	kkh.com.sg	General enquiries.
Alexandra Hospital (AH)	6908 2222	ah.com.sg	General enquiries.

Caregiving and community support

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
Agency for Integrated Care (AIC)	1800 650 6060	aic.sg	Mon to Fri 8:30am to 8:30pm, Sat 8:30am to 4pm. Bereavement and caregiver support referrals.
AIC, When Death Occurs	online	aic.sg / Caregiving-Support / When-Death-Occurs	Grief support service directory.
AMP Helpline	6416 3960	amp.org.sg / amp-helpline	Mon to Fri 10am to 5pm. Emotional support for Malay/Muslim families. Alt: 6416 3961.
MENDAKI	online	my.mendaki.org.sg	Education assistance for surviving dependants.

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
PERGAS	online	pergas.org.sg	Asatizah Solace Care emotional and spiritual support.

Muslim-affirming and general mental health

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
Club HEAL	6899 3463	clubheal.org.sg	Muslim-focused mental wellness. Mon to Fri 9am to 5pm.
SAMH (Singapore Association for Mental Health)	1800 283 7019	samhealth.org.sg	Mon to Sat 9am to 5pm.
Silver Ribbon Singapore	6386 1928	silverribbonsingapore.com	Counselling and emotional support.

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
Institute of Mental Health (IMH)	6389 2000	imh.com.sg	General enquiries. (The standalone IMH mental health helpline 6389 2222 was replaced by National Mindline 1771 on 18 Jun 2025.)

Inheritance and Syariah Court

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
Syariah Court Singapore	6354 8371	syariahcourt.gov.sg / contact	Mon to Fri 8:30am to 5pm. Address: 1 Havelock Square Singapore 059724.

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
Syariah Court Inheritance Certificate	online	syariahcourt.gov.sg / Inheritance	\$34 application fee, 7-day processing window, 60-day validity.
Syariah Court email	inheritance@syariahcourt.gov.sg	syariahcourt.gov.sg / contact	Inheritance certificate enquiries (listed on the official contact page).
Family Justice Courts	6435 5077	judiciary.gov.sg / family	For Grant of Probate and Letters of Administration.

Muslim funeral service providers (publicly listed)

Singapore Muslim families with inheritance or family law matters should engage a lawyer experienced in Syariah law. The Law Society of Singapore directory lets you search by practice area.

Service	Phone	Website	Notes (verified 2026-05-23)
Law Society of Singapore	6538 2500	lawsociety.org.sg	Use the Find a Lawyer directory; filter by practice area to find Muslim law / probate practitioners.
Community Justice Centre	6557 4100	cjc.org.sg	Pro bono and self-represented litigant support.
Legal Aid Bureau (Muslim Family Law applications)	1800 325 1424	mlaw.gov.sg / lab	Means-tested legal aid for civil matters.

How to read this list

- Every entry has a public source URL. If a service is not listed publicly, it is not in this file by design.
- Phone numbers are reproduced exactly as published. Where the format differs (e.g. 10 digits, prefixed, hyphenated), it has been normalised for the table.
- *Notes (verified)* is the date the maintainer checked the source page.

If a number is wrong, please open a pull request with the public URL that supports the correction.

Glossary

Arabic terms glossary

Arabic terms

These short definitions are for orientation only. For deeper meaning, consult an asatizah.

- **adab**: etiquette, manners, especially in religious practice.
- **al-Fatihah**: the opening chapter of the Quran, recited in every prayer.
- **asabah**: agnatic heirs in faraid, who receive the residue after fixed shares.
- **ashabul furud**: Quranic heirs in faraid, who receive fixed fractions.
- **awrah**: parts of the body that must be covered, varying by context and gender.
- **baitulmal**: the Islamic public treasury, administered by MUIS in Singapore.
- **bid'ah**: a religious innovation. Scholars distinguish between accepted and rejected innovations.
- **du'a**: supplication, asking Allah.
- **faraid**: the Islamic system of fixed inheritance shares.
- **fardhu kifayah**: a communal religious obligation. If enough people fulfil it, the rest are excused.
- **fiqh**: Islamic jurisprudence, the human understanding of shariah.
- **ghusl**: ritual washing. For the deceased, ghusl jenazah.
- **hadith**: a recorded saying or act of the Prophet, peace be upon him.
- **hayah mustaqirra**: stable life, used in fiqh discussions of brain death.
- **hibah**: a gift made during one's lifetime, valid when possession transfers.
- **hibah ruqba**: a gift conditional on survivorship.
- **ihdad**: the mourning practices observed by a widow during iddah.

- **ihram**: a state of consecration; used differently in pilgrimage and in prayer beginnings (takbiratul ihram).
- **ikhtilaf**: scholarly difference of opinion.
- **imam**: prayer leader. In a community, often the resident scholar of a mosque.
- **inna lillahi wa inna ilayhi raji'un**: "indeed, we belong to Allah, and to Him we shall return."
- **istighfar**: seeking forgiveness, often the phrase "astaghfirullah".
- **istinja**: cleaning of the private areas after using the toilet, also applied during ghusl.
- **janazah**: a deceased person's body. Solat janazah is the funeral prayer.
- **jenazah**: the Bahasa Melayu spelling of janazah, used in Singapore.
- **kafan**: the plain white shroud used for burial.
- **lahad**: a niche cut into the side wall of a grave to receive the body.
- **la ilaha illallah**: "there is no god but Allah", the core of the shahadah.
- **la yurja bur'uh**: a fiqh term meaning "no realistic hope of recovery", used in end-of-life decisions.
- **lifafah**: a full body wrap of the kafan.
- **maslaha**: public benefit, a principle in Islamic jurisprudence.
- **madhab**: a school of Islamic legal thought, plural mazahib. Singapore default is Shafi'i.
- **mufti**: a scholar qualified to issue fatwa. The Mufti of Singapore heads the MUIS Office of the Mufti.
- **niat**: intention, required at the start of an act of worship.
- **niyahah**: loud wailing in grief, which is prohibited in Islam.
- **nuzriah**: a conditional gift, typically taking effect on death.
- **qabdh**: possession or taking delivery, required for a hibah to be complete.
- **qadar**: divine decree.
- **qibla**: the direction of the Kaaba in Makkah, faced during prayer.
- **qamees**: the inner shirt layer of the kafan.

- **redha**: acceptance and contentment with Allah's decree.
- **rukū**: the bowing position in salah. Absent in solat jenazah.
- **sabr**: patience, perseverance in the face of difficulty without complaint to creation.
- **sadaqah**: voluntary charity.
- **salaf**: the early generations of Muslims after the Prophet, peace be upon him.
- **salam**: the closing greeting of prayer, "Assalamu alaikum wa rahmatullahi wa barakatuh".
- **salawat**: prayer of blessing upon the Prophet, peace be upon him.
- **shahadah**: the testimony of faith, "la ilaha illallah, Muhammadur rasulullah".
- **sighah**: a specific pronouncement that gives a religious vow its legal effect.
- **sinaband**: the waist wrap from armpits to thigh in a female kafan.
- **solat / salah**: the obligatory daily prayer. Solat jenazah is the funeral prayer.
- **sujud**: the prostration position in salah. Absent in solat jenazah.
- **sunnah**: the practice of the Prophet, peace be upon him.
- **tahlil**: a gathering for du'a and Quran recitation in remembrance of the deceased.
- **takbir**: saying "Allahu Akbar".
- **takbiratul ihram**: the opening takbir that begins a prayer.
- **talqin**: gently prompting a dying person to recite the shahadah; also the graveside reminder in the Shafi'i tradition.
- **tawakkal**: trust in Allah, including in matters of life and death.
- **tawhid**: the oneness of Allah.
- **ta'ziyah**: offering condolences to a bereaved family.
- **ustaz**: a male religious teacher. Ustazah for female.
- **waris**: heir.
- **wasiat**: an Islamic will, governed in Singapore by AMLA.

- **wudhu**: ritual ablution before prayer. Also performed on the body during *ghusl jenazah*.
- **zikir**: the remembrance of Allah, often a phrase repeated quietly.

Bahasa Melayu terms glossary

Bahasa Melayu terms

These short definitions reflect everyday usage in the Singapore Malay-Muslim community.

- **asatizah**: religious teachers and scholars. In Singapore, recognised under the **Asatizah Recognition Scheme (ARS)**.
- **bilal**: a person who calls the *adhan* (call to prayer). Also used for community members trained in *jenazah* duties at some mosques.
- **bid'ah**: an innovation in religious practice (loanword from Arabic). Scholars distinguish accepted from rejected innovations.
- **bantuan**: assistance.
- **doa**: du'a, supplication.
- **dukacita**: condolences.
- **hibah**: a lifetime gift in Islamic law (also Arabic).
- **jurumandi**: a trained washer of the deceased.
- **jenazah**: the deceased body. *Pengurus jenazah* are those who manage funeral matters.
- **kapur barus**: camphor, used in the final pour during *ghusl jenazah*.
- **kafan**: shroud (also Arabic).
- **kenduri arwah**: a commemorative meal and du'a gathering for the deceased.
- **kursus pengurusan jenazah**: a community course on managing Muslim funeral matters.
- **lahad**: the side niche cut into a grave (also Arabic).

- **mandi jenazah**: the *ghusl* of the deceased, and also the tray or platform used for it.
- **masjid**: mosque.
- **muis**: the Islamic Religious Council of Singapore (Majlis Ugama Islam Singapura).
- **nafkah**: maintenance, especially in family law.
- **pengurus jenazah**: community members or teams who manage Muslim funeral matters.
- **rahimahullah**: "may Allah have mercy on him", commonly added after a deceased Muslim's name.
- **rumah pertubuhan**: an organisation's premises, often referred to in community contexts (for example AMP Rumah Pertubuhan).
- **sabar**: patience (also Arabic *sabr*).
- **solat jenazah**: the funeral prayer (also Arabic *salah*).
- **takziah**: condolences (also Arabic *ta'ziyah*).
- **tahlil**: a gathering of recitation and du'a for the deceased (also Arabic).
- **tukang mandi**: a trained washer of the deceased.
- **ustaz / ustazah**: male / female religious teacher.
- **waris**: heir (also Arabic).
- **wasiat**: an Islamic will (also Arabic).
- **wakaf**: an Islamic endowment.

Singapore-specific institutional terms

- **AMP**: Association of Muslim Professionals, amp.org.sg.
- **MUIS**: Majlis Ugama Islam Singapura, muis.gov.sg.
- **PERGAS**: Singapore Islamic Scholars and Religious Teachers Association, pergas.org.sg.
- **MENDAKI**: Yayasan MENDAKI, mendaki.org.sg.
- **Masjid Pusara Aman**: the mosque located at the Muslim cemetery in Lim Chu Kang.

- **Pusara Aman / Pusara Abadi:** sections within the Choa Chu Kang Muslim Cemetery, the only active Muslim burial site in Singapore.
- **My Legacy:** the Singapore government portal for end-of-life paperwork, mylegacy.life.gov.sg.
- **NEA:** National Environment Agency, administers cemeteries.
- **ICA:** Immigration and Checkpoints Authority, handles death registration.
- **AIC:** Agency for Integrated Care, the eldercare and community care agency.
- **AMLA:** the Administration of Muslim Law Act, the statutory basis for Muslim law in Singapore.
- **Syariah Court:** the Singapore Syariah Court, syariahcourt.gov.sg.

End of booklet

This is the end of the SG Muslim Care Companion booklet. Updates and the latest version are at github.com/ahnrusty/sg-muslim-care-companion.

May Allah ease the path for every family that picks this up.